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Riccardo Quinto

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MEDIOEVO

RIVISTA DI STORIA DELLA FILOSOFIA MEDIEVALE

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Filosofia e teologia nel XII secolo
e nei primi decenni del XIII secolo

Philosophy and Theology in the 12th Century
and in the first Decades of the 13th Century

a cura di
Riccardo Quinto

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PRESENTAZIONE

Il presente volume di «Medioevo» raccoglie il frutto di una serie di ricerche condotte nel corso degli ultimi anni nell'ambito del Centro Interdipartimentale per Ricerche di Filosofia Medievale dell'Università di Padova e del Seminario di Filosofia Medievale attivo all'interno della Scuola di Dottorato di Ricerca in Filosofia di Padova. Alcuni dei testi qui pubblicati sono versioni più ampie di relazioni presentate durante il seminario "La filosofia nel XII secolo" (tenuto nell'anno accademico 2007-2008): così gli articoli di Marco Rainini su Corrado di Hirsau e di Caterina Tarlazzi su Alchero "di Clairvaux" testimoniano la fecondità di un approccio agli autori medievali che riservi una particolare attenzione alla loro fortuna storiografica e che sottoponga a una critica attenta non solo la tradizione manoscritta, ma anche la più antica diffusione a stampa dei loro testi. Altri saggi nascono in relazione a un'attività didattica e di ricerca che prosegue con continuità da diversi anni, dedicata a "L'edizione critica dei testi medievali filosofici e teologici": si offrono così al lettore le edizioni critiche di tre delle Quaestiones theologiae *di Stefano Langton. I tre testi – editi da Magdalena Bieniak, Massimiliano d'Alessandro, Giovanni Paolo Maggioni e Riccardo Quinto –, pur dedicati a temi disparati (i doni dello Spirito Santo, il sacrificio di Abramo e il confronto tra vita attiva e contemplativa), sono studiati insieme allo scopo di evidenziare la loro relazione con dispute teologiche effettivamente celebrate nella scuola del Langton a Parigi. I due ampi saggi raccolgono così una serie di dati preziosi in vista dell'edizione complessiva dell'opera maggiore del Langton, che gli stessi studiosi stanno preparando per la serie degli* Auctores Britannici Medii Aevi. *A questa linea di ricerca si possono ricondurre anche gli interventi di Mark Clark, Constant Mews e Clare Monagle: lo studio di Clark è direttamente legato all'edizione critica del commento del Langton alla* Historia scholastica *di Pietro Comestore, in preparazione per il* Corpus Christianorum; *quello di Mews e Monagle offre invece un ampio affresco*

dei dibattiti dottrinali sviluppatisi a Parigi dopo la morte di Pier Lombardo (1160) e del loro riflesso sulle decisioni del Concilio Laterano IV (1215).

*All'analisi della letteratura più strettamente filosofica che arricchisce il contesto parigino tra la fine del XII e l'inizio del XIII secolo sono dedicati i due saggi che incorniciano il numero: Francesco Bottin indaga alcuni aspetti dell'antropologia avicenniana e della sua ricezione in ambito latino, mentre Irene Zavattero studia la definizione di filosofia morale in uno dei primi commenti latini all'*Etica Nicomachea *di Aristotele.*

RICCARDO QUINTO

FRANCESCO BOTTIN

UNIBILITAS. BACK TO THE SOURCE OF THE SOUL'S UNIBILITY TO THE BODY

1. *UNIBILITAS* AND THEOLOGY OF THE PERSON

In the thirteenth century, the understanding of the soul-body relation was undoubtedly a highly controversial subject, and yet the leading thinkers of the time appear to agree on one aspect of this relation. Both Bonaventure and Thomas Aquinas, despite their deeply different anthropological conceptions, adopt a particular doctrine which had been progressively elaborated by theologians from the late twelfth century onwards,[1] thus endowing the concept of *unibilitas* with a special role in determining the relation between soul and body.

Bonaventure of Bagnoregio introduces the unibility concept in order to distinguish between angelic forms and human souls. According to him, both angelic forms and human souls are composed of a substantial form and a spiritual matter, hence they cannot be distinguished by this aspect. That which specifically differentiates

1. Cf. E. Gilson, *History of Christian Philosophy in the Middle Ages*, Sheed and Ward, London, New York 1980, 360-362; B.C. Bazán, *Pluralisme de formes ou dualisme de substances?*, « Rev. philos. Louvain », 67 (1969), 30-73. Although in a climate of strong controversy between Dominicans and Franciscans, the anonymous author of the *Corruptorium corruptoris "Quaestione"* pointed out the fundamental agreement between Aquinas and Bonaventure precisely on *unibilitas*: « Miror istam hominum malivolam insipientiam, cui invidia excaecati in dictis unius doctoris [Aquinas] reprobare non verentur id ipsum quod in dictis alterius laudant. Nam Bonaventura, quam laudant, id ipsum dicit quod hic calumniatur in Thoma » (cf. *Le Correctorium corruptoris "Quaestione"*, ed. J.-F. Müller, Herder, Roma 1954 [Studia Anselmiana, 35], 150).

ginum – and were able to prove that all of them were written by the same author. These conclusions agree with information provided by the German abbot Johannes Trithemius in several of his works from the late 15th and early 16th century, in which he maintains that the author of these texts was a certain Conrad, a monk at Hirsau writing around 1140. Trithemius is not usually considered to be a reliable historical source (partly with good reason, for some of his information is inaccurate and he sometimes refers to chronicles and authors of his own invention). Nevertheless, a careful examination of Conrad's works (and, among them, the *Dialogus de cruce*, a text only recently attributed to him), and other sources, proves that Trithemius's information on Conrad is reliable and suggests that Trithemius may have had access to the library of Hirsau before it was dispersed.

« Medioevo », 35 (2010), 37-80.

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Peter Lombard, Joachim of Fiore, and the Fourth Lateran Council

This paper examines the intellectual and religious debates involved in the action of the Fourth Lateran Council in condemning the criticism made by Joachim of Fiore of Peter Lombard's understanding of the Trinity. The authors argue that this condemnation, of decisive influence in shaping the direction of scholastic theology in the 13th century, marks the victory of one particular school of thought being developed in Paris in the second half of the 12th century, that of Peter Lombard, as well of his particular way of understanding God as *summa quaedam res*, conceptually distinct from the three divine persons, even if they shared in the same divine nature. While Lombard was inspired by a phrase of Augustine's *De doctrina Christiana*, he subtly rephrased Augustine's argument in a way that was seen by Richard of St. Victor as creating unnecessary separation between the divine persons and the dynamic nature of God as love that flowed into the divine persons. The authors argue that Joachim's objection to Lombard's analysis was inspired by Richard of St. Victor's own critique of Lombard's understanding of the Trinity, distinct from and perhaps more cogent than the accusations made about Lombard's Christology by his critics, many of whom were connected in some way to St. Victor. The official support given to Peter Lombard at Lateran IV was intimately connected to the desire of Innocent III and his senior advisers to create an unchallenged foundation for theological orthodoxy at the newly established University of Paris.

« Medioevo », 35 (2010), 81-122.

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Peter Comestor and Stephen Langton: Master and Student, and Co-Makers of the Historia scholastica

In the article the chronology of Stephen Langton's career as a theologian in Paris is revisited, and the author argues that the newly-established timeframe makes it likely that Langton was in fact Peter Comestor's student. Moreover, on the basis of information provided by Langton in his commentaries on the *Historia scholastica*, he argues that Langton and Comestor worked together on the *Historia scholastica* and that Langton is the key to understanding the early textual history of that work.

« Medioevo », 35 (2010), 123-150.

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Le quaestiones *di Stefano Langton sui doni dello Spirito Santo e sul sacrificio di Abramo*

The paper takes the edition of two of Stephen Langton's *Quaestiones theologiae* as an opportunity to provide a summary of our knowledge of the manuscript transmission of this work. The two edited *quaestiones*, though not ideologically linked to each other, belong to a special group of eight *quaestiones* which are present in the same order in all four different collections that preserve Langton's 200 theological *quaestiones*. Through a detailed philological analysis, the authors argue that a) the four sub-archetypes of the *quaestiones* (two preserved, and two lost after having been copied) all copied directly one and the same ar-

Constant J. Mews - Clare Monagle

PETER LOMBARD, JOACHIM OF FIORE AND THE FOURTH LATERAN COUNCIL

The publication in 1994 of *Peter Lombard*, Marcia Colish's magisterial study of the author of the *Sentences*, as well as of Philipp Rosemann's more compact monograph on the same subject ten years later, has inspired a new wave of interest in this most important of twelfth-century thinkers. Taken as a whole, this revival of interest in Peter Lombard (d. 1160) opens a new window upon his achievement.[1] In terms of the canon of twelfth-century thinkers, Peter Lombard has often suffered in comparison to the flashier and more obviously original Peter Abelard (1079-1142). Where Abelard has been seen as an innovator, Peter Lombard has tended to be considered as a master compiler. But new research is conveying a much more complicated perspective, one that is sensitive

1. Peter Lombard, *Sententiae in IV libris distinctae*, ed. I. Brady, Editiones Collegii S. Bonaventurae ad Claras Aquas, Grottaferrata 1971-1981 (Spicilegium Bonaventurianum, 4-5); Peter Lombard, *The Sentences: Book 1 The Mystery of the Trinity*, trans. G. Silano, Pontifical Institute of Mediaeval Studies, Toronto 2007. *Book 2: On Creation* and *Book 3: On the Incarnation of the Word* were published in the same series in 2008; *Book 4* has still to appear. See also M. Colish, *Peter Lombard*, 2 vols, Brill, Leiden 1994; P. Rosemann, *Peter Lombard*, Oxford University Press, New York 2004 and P. Rosemann, *The Story of a Great Medieval Book*, University of Toronto Press, Toronto 2007, and *Pietro Lombardo: Atti del XLII Convegno storico internazionale, Todi, 8-10 ottobre 2006*, Fondazione Centro Italiano di Studi sull'Alto Medioevo, Spoleto 2007. We are indebted to Sylvain Piron, Dominique Poirel, and Gian-Luca Potestà for comments on earlier versions of this paper, as well as to colleagues from the School of Historical Studies, Monash University.

to the very subtle and very precise theological innovations of Lombard. An increasingly nuanced picture is being drawn of the *Sentences* and the manifest ways in which this work transformed the practice of theology in the latter part of the twelfth century.

In this article, we join this chorus of interest in Peter Lombard's legacy, but do so by focusing on the controversial character of his discussion of the Trinity. One of the strongest indicators of the importance accorded to the *Sentences* by ecclesiastical authority can be found in the statutes of the Fourth Lateran Council of 1215. There, Peter Lombard's Trinitarian theology was proclaimed as orthodox by the Council while the criticisms of it made by Joachim of Fiore (d. 1202) were rejected. Such endorsement of a particular schoolman was unprecedented and goes some way to demonstrate the impact of the *Sentences* upon the schools and the papacy. This article seeks to unpack this offical approval, placing it in the context of the intellectual activity of the schools in the previous fifty years, in particular since the Third Lateran Council of 1179. In so doing, we hope to gain greater understanding of the popularity and impact of the *Book of Sentences* so as to explain why and how it was so fundamental to the intellectual culture of the high middle ages.

Lateran IV

The endorsement of Peter Lombard at the Fourth Lateran Council of 1215 was bold and decisive. In a major break with established tradition, Pope Innocent III promulgated the Council's declaration of Christian orthodoxy with a vigorous refutation of allegations that had been made by abbot Joachim of Fiore that Lombard's Trinitarian theology – or at least a particular passage near the beginning of the *Sentences* (I, d. 5, c. 1) – was heretical, positing a quaternity instead of a Trinity:

> We therefore condemn and reprove that small book or treatise which abbot Joachim published against master Peter Lombard concerning the unity or essence of the Trinity, in which he calls Peter Lombard a heretic and a madman because he said in his *Sentences*: « For there is a certain supreme thing (*res*) which is the Father and the Son and the holy Spirit, and it neither begets nor is begotten, nor does it proceed ». He asserts from this that Peter Lombard ascribes to God not so much a Trinity as a quaternity, that is to say three persons and a common essence, as if this were a fourth. Abbot Joachim clearly protests that there does not exist any thing (*res*) which is the Father and the Son and the holy Spirit – neither an essence nor a substance nor a nature – although he concedes that the Father and the Son and the holy Spirit are one essence, once substance, and one nature.[2]

After quoting at some length from Joachim to argue that it was the abbot rather than Lombard who was denying that the Trinity constituted a supreme thing (*res*), the Pope then declared orthodox faith *cum Petro* – subtly connecting the author of the *Sentences* with the first of the apostles. The Pope or his theological adviser then went on to offer a definition of orthodox faith, silently correcting the phrase quoted inaccurately by Joachim (*quaedam summa res*) from Lombard's *Sentences*, with a more accurate version, adding the term « one » (*una quaedam summa res*).

> We, however, with the approval of this sacred and universal Council, believe and confess with Peter that there exists a certain one supreme thing (*res*), incomprehensible and ineffable, which truly is the Father and the Son and the holy Spirit, the three persons together and each one of them separately. Therefore in God there is only a Trinity, not a quaternity, since each of the three persons is that thing – that is to say substance, essence or divine nature – which alone is the principle of all things, besides which no other principle can be found.[3]

2. *Conciliorum Oecumenicorum Decreta*, ed. J. Alberigo, J.A. Dossetti, P.P. Joannou, C. Leonardi, P. Prodi, H. Jedin, Istituto per le scienze religiose di Bologna, Bologna 1973, 230-271, especially 231-232, reprinted with the same pagination in an English translation, *Decrees of the Ecumenical Councils*, ed. Norman J. Tanner, Sheed & Ward, London 1990: « Damnamus ergo et reprobamus libellum sive tractatum quem abbas Ioachim edidit contra magistrum Petrum Lombardum de unitate seu essentia trinitatis appellans ipsum haereticum et insanum pro eo quod in suis dixit sententiis quoniam quaedam summa res est pater et filius et spiritus sanctus et illa non est generans neque genita nec procedens unde asserit quod ille non tam trinitatem quam quaternitatem adstruebat in deo videlicet tres personas et illam communem essentiam quasi quartam manifeste protestans quod nulla res est quae sit pater et filius et spiritus sanctus nec est essentia nec substantia nec natura quamvis concedat quod pater et filius et spiritus sanctus sunt una essentia una substantia unaque natura ».

3. *Conciliorum Oecumenicorum Decreta*, 232; in the Tanner translation, *cum Petro* is rendered as "with Peter Lombard" « Nos autem sacro et universali concilio ap-

Translating *res* in English as "reality" perhaps conveys more fluently than "thing" a notion that for Peter Lombard was unexceptional, but seemed highly contentious to Joachim. The Pope, speaking through the Council, used the opportunity to counter Joachim's critique of Lombard with a definition of orthodox Christian belief. He then went on to condemn various other heresies and malpractices in the Church, but without any of the detail accorded the challenge to Lombard's authority by Joachim. Nothing could be more serious than to challenge the Christian doctrine of the Trinity and unity of God.

Lateran IV is rightly considered a watershed Council, bringing about a new era of papal oversight and organisation. This endorsement of Peter Lombard must be understood as occurring in the context of one of the most activist councils in history. It put forward a bold reform agenda. A crusade was preached, clerical participation in ordeals was banished and the notion of transubstantiation was used officially for the first time.[4] It prohibited the establishment of any new religious orders beyond those that had already been approved. And as well, of course, there is its defence of Peter Lombard, seeming to mark a decisive victory for scholastic theology over that of the monasteries, with a schoolman from northern Italy, who had made his career in Paris, being acclaimed at the expense of a Calabrian monk who had never been to France.

Certainly, an initial glance at the language of the constitutions of Lateran IV might suggest this adversarial reading. A closer reading of the debates around Peter Lombard's orthodoxy before 1215 suggests, however, a more complicated set of positions emanating from the Council. Peter Lombard's reputation up until Lateran IV was in fact highly contested both within and outside of the

probante credimus et confitemur cum Petro quod una quaedam summa res est incomprehensibilis quidem et ineffabilis quae veraciter est pater et filius et spiritus sanctus, tres simul personae ac sigillatim quaelibet earundem et ideo in deo trinitas est solummodo non quaternitas, quia quaelibet trium personarum est illa res videlicet substantia essentia sive natura divina quae sola est universorum principium praeter quod aliud inveniri non potest...».

4. Cfr. J. Goering, *The invention of transubstantiation*, «Traditio», 46 (1991), 147-170.

schools. Considerable attention has been given to the debate provoked by his Christology in the second half of the twelfth century.[5] These criticisms focused upon Book 3 of the *Sentences*, where Peter Lombard had determined to clarify the terms of the hypostatic union, thereby resolving certain patristic contradictions in this regard. Throughout the 1170s, two Augustinian canons, John of Cornwall (d. c. 1200), a former student of Peter Lombard, and Walter, subprior (1162-73) and then prior of St-Victor until his death (c. 1180-90), construed him as effectively another Abelard, misusing dialectical sophistry to distort Christian belief.[6] While disagreement with Peter Lombard is often presented as the product of arch-conservatives being unwilling to adapt to the demands of scholastic debate, we shall argue that important criticism of his theology was also made by two much more analytic thinkers associated with St-Victor, namely Achard (d. 1170), abbot of St-Victor from 1155 to 1161, and Richard of St-Victor, its prior from 1162 until his death in 1173. They constructed a vein of critique not just of Lombard's Christology, but also of his theology of the Trinity. While Peter Lombard himself drew on themes developed by Hugh of St-Victor during the 1130s, he combined these insights with a style of argumentation from conflicting authorities established by Peter Abelard. Certain canons of St-Victor would view Lombard as betraying the legacy established by Hugh. Joachim of Fiore extended this current of suspicion towards Lombard's achievement. The endorsement *cum Petro* at Lateran IV represents not merely a blanket endorsement of the schools, but a particular intervention into a long-standing argument between between these critics and loyal disciples of Peter Lombard, many of whom had been trained at the cathedral school of Notre Dame.

5. See most recently, Pietro B. Rossi, *Contra Lombardum: reazioni alla cristologia di Pietro Lombardo*, in *Pietro Lombardo* (n. 1 above), 123-191.

6. See John of Cornwall, *Eulogium* ed. N. Häring, *The Eulogium ad Alexandrum Papam tertium of John of Cornwall*, «Med. Stud.», 13 (1951), 253-300; P. Glorieux, *Le Contra quatuor labyrinthos Franciae de Gauthier de Saint-Victor*, «Arch. Hist. Doctr. Litt. M. A.», 19 (1952), 187-355.

Taken together, we argue, these criticisms made against Peter Lombard's Trinitarian theology registered a particular concern with the practice of referring to abstract theological notions without a concrete or spiritual reality (*res*) in themselves. Peter Lombard's critics were suspicious of any reflection on the divine essence that seemed to diminish its divine nature within the three persons, or the reality (*res*) of Christ as Son of God. The criticisms they made of Lombard's Christological and Trinitarian thought reflected genuine fear that speaking through abstract theological notions undermined the dynamic reality central to the incarnation and the Trinity. Joachim's criticisms of Peter Lombard's Trinitarian theology deserve, therefore, to be taken seriously. The Lateran Council nonetheless endorsed the fundamental orthodoxy of Lombard's articulation of the Trinitarian essence as a reality (*una quaedam summa res*) conceptually distinct from the divine persons against his critics. How did the Council get to this point of intervention? In order to answer this question, it is necessary to retrace the origins and trajectories of the *Sentences* and its author, as well as the inspiration behind Lombard's particular definition of supreme reality.

Peter Lombard, Augustine and Abelard

Peter Lombard is not known to have studied secular philosophy in Paris. All we know is that he came from Novara in Lombardy to study in France, initially at Reims under Alberic (d. 1141), who taught there from 1121 to 1136.[7] Reims may have had a particular connection to Lombardy through Alberic's colleague, Lotulph of Novara, a fellow-disciple of Anselm of Laon (d. 1117). Under Alberic, its cathedral school had become well-known as a place where teaching focused not on secular philosophy, but on scripture and orthodox doctrine.[8] Peter Lombard came to Paris in

7. Lombard's connection to Novara is reported in the rubric of an early copy of the *Sentences*, Munich, Bayerische Staatsbibliothek, Clm 18109 (Brady, vol. I. 10*).

8. Hugh Primas, *Carmen* 18, *The Oxford Poems of Hugh Primas and the Arundel Lyrics*, ed. C.J. McDonough, Pontifical Institute of Mediaeval Studies, Toronto 1984

around 1134, armed with a letter from Bernard of Clairvaux to the abbot of St-Victor commending him as a *virum venerabilem*, whom Bernard had helped support at Reims at the request of the bishop of Lucca. In transferring from Reims to Paris, he was moving from an ancient cathedral school that took pride in its tradition, to an emerging urban centre with a multiplicity of schools, and increasing interest in the study of secular philosophy.[9] Peter Abelard, who had himself tangled with Alberic of Reims and Lotulph in theological controversy at the Council of Soissons in 1121, was then the dominant teacher at Sainte-Geneviève, while Hugh was the leading figure at St-Victor. We do not know how long Peter Lombard studied under Hugh of St-Victor before moving to Notre-Dame. By around 1142, however, he was already reported to be a celebrated theologian, at least according to the author of the *Metamorphosis Goliae*, written soon after the death of Peter Abelard.[10] It seems likely that he had already started teaching at

(Toronto Medieval Latin Texts), 62-63: «Remis enim per etatem / Prima<ra> tenet dignitatem. / Set, quod habet ab antiquo, Nunc augetur sub Albrico. / Per hunc Remis urbs suprema, / Per hunc portat diadema;... Non leguntur hic poete, / Set Iohannes et prophete. / Non est scola uanitatis, / Set doctrina ueritatis. / Ibi nomen non Socratis, / Set eterne trinitatis». Hugh, writing sometime before 1136, also mentions another Lombard as a member of his school, as well as a certain Oto, all living there as holy hermits: «Et cum eo Adelardus / Valde dives Lango-bardus; / Generosus puer Oto / Et quam plures pari uoto / Hic aggressi uiam uite / Sacri degunt heremite».

9. Bernard of Clairvaux, Epistola 410, in *Sancti Bernardi Opera*, vol. VIII, ed. J. Leclercq and C. H. Talbot, Editiones Cistercienses, Rome 1977, 391.

10. *Metamorphosis Goliae* 50, ed. R.B.C. Huygens, *CCCM* 171A, Brepols, Turnhout 2000, 805-815, esp. 813: «Celebrem theologum vidimus Lumbardum, / cum Yvone Helyam Petrum et Bernardum, / quorum opobalsamum spirat os et nardum, / et professi plurimi sunt Abaielardum». Huygens first published this text as *Die Metamorphose des Golias*, «Studi Medievali», IIIa ser., 3 (1962), 764-772. Vim Verbaal has argued that the poem refers to Abelard, whose absence is alluded to in the poem, as still alive and that he must therefore have died in 1143, not 1142 as most chronicles attest, in *The Council of Sens reconsidered: masters, monks, or judges?*, «Church History», 74 (2005), 460-494, n. 64, picking up a suggestion originally made by J.F. Benton, *Philology's Search for Abelard in the Metamorphosis Goliae*, originally published in «Speculum», 50 (1975), 199-217, reprinted in J.F. Benton, *Culture, Power and Personality in Medieval France*, ed. T.N. Bisson, The Hambledon Press, London 1991, 455-474. Yet Abelard's absence coupled with the allusion to Gilbert as «Et hic pre-

the cathedral school of Notre-Dame. With the deaths of Hugh of St-Victor in 1141 and of Peter Abelard in 1142, as well as the departure of Gilbert de la Porrée (d. 1154) from Paris to become bishop of Poitiers sometime after July 1142, Peter Lombard was able to emerge as a major theologian in his own right. Bernard's intervention against Abelard in 1141 and then against Gilbert at Reims in 1148 (supported by Peter Lombard) indirectly helped strengthen the Lombard's reputation as a voice of orthodoxy. While Brady has argued that he is the same person as *Petrus puerus* mentioned at Notre-Dame in 1144-1145, a *magister Petrus subdiaconus* in 1150 at Notre-Dame, and a *Petrus archidiaconus* in 1157, no document firmly identifies Peter Lombard as a canon of the cathedral.[11] Robert of Torigny refers to Peter Lombard only as a *magister*, not as a canon, when he was offered the bishopric in June 1159 by Philip, brother of Louis VII and dean of Notre-Dame after a long vacancy, following the death of bishop Theobald in January 1158.[12] Even if he was a cathedral canon, his reputation was not fully secure.

Lombard had initially established his reputation by glossing the Psalms and the Epistles of St Paul in a manner established by Anselm of Laon and continued by Gilbert of Poitiers.[13] Exactly when he completed these glosses, originally composed for private use, is not certain.[14] In a treatise originally written in 1142, Gerhoch of Reichersberg castigated the lack of Christological orthodoxy of «great teachers who have inserted falsehood in their glosses on the Apostle, in particular master Anselm and master Gilbert and most recently Peter Lombard». Although Brady has suggested that Gerhoch may have added the phrase «and most recently Peter Lombard» to his original treatise only after death in 1160, Peter Lombard was already becoming known as a major theologian in the 1140s.[15] He established his reputation by making conscious appeal to the authority of patristic tradition, as articulated by Anselm of Laon, rather than that of philosophy.

That Peter Lombard chose to open his discussion of the Trinity in the *Sentences* by referring not to pagan authors in the fashion of Abelard in his *Theologia* or to Boethius like Gilbert of Poitiers in his commentaries on the *Opuscula sacra*, but to Augustine – in par-

sul presulum stat Pictaviensis», suggests that it must have been written not long after his appointment to the see of Poitiers (after July 1142), but before he had moved there, implying that the poem was written in the second half of 1142. Where Gilbert taught in Paris is not known, although possibly it was at the cathedral school of Notre-Dame, in which case Peter Lombard, who was certainly familiar with Gilbert's thought, could have been appointed as his successor. In 1148, however, Peter Lombard and Robert of Melun led a bitter attack on Gilbert at the Council of Reims: cfr. John of Salisbury, *Historia pontificalis* 8, ed. M. Chibnall, Clarendon Press, Oxford 1986 (Oxford Medieval Texts), 16.

11. I.C. Brady concluded that he was a canon of Notre-Dame by 1145, *Peter Lombard: Canon of Notre-Dame*, «Rech. Théol. Anc. Méd.», 32 (1965), 277-295, and again in his introduction to the *Sentences*, vol. I, 21*-25*, arguments assumed to be conclusive by Colish, *Peter Lombard*, 20-23. Brady suggests that Lombard could be the *Petrum puerum* who signs documents 1145-1147, although these charters do not describe him as *magister*, unusual if he was already a well-known *magister* at this time, and already a *vir venerabilis* (according to Bernard) in 1134. Brady (11*, 23*) acknowleges that he is mentioned as *magister Petrus Longobardus*, but not as a canon, in a charter of 1154, when he signs a document after *magister Bernardus archidiaconus Parisiensis*, but before *Gualterus canonicus* (of Notre-Dame). A document of 1147 refers to *Petrus subdiaconus*, one of around 1150 to *magister Petrus subdiaconus* (18*), and another of 1157 to *Petrus archidiaconus* (24*-25*) could refer to Peter Lombard. A thirteenth-century report that mentions that a house hired out by Peter Lombard as bishop to a certain canon, Henry of Orly, came back into the possession of the cathedral chapter (19*-20*), suggests but is not in itself firm evidence that he was a canon before becoming bishop of Paris.

12. Brady (33*), followed by Colish (*Peter Lombard*, 22 n. 21) reports how the *Continuatio Bexense* reports that *magister Petrus Longobardus* was elected bishop of Paris *conivente Philippo eiusdem ecclesiae decano*. The political uncertainty around the election is also discussed by P. Michaud-Quantin, *Les évêques de Paris dans la seconde moitié du XIIe siècle* in *Huitième centenaire de Notre-Dame de Paris (Congrès des 30 mai-3 juin 1964)*, Vrin, Paris 1964, 23-33, esp. 24-25.

13. On Peter Lombard's close debt to Anselm of Laon's interlinear glosses, see Patrizia Stoppacci, *Le Glosse continuate in Psalmos di Pietro Lombardo. Status quaestionis: studi pregressi e prospettive di ricerca* and Mark Zier, *Peter Lombard and the Glossa Ordinaria: A Missing Link?*, in *Pietro Lombardo*, 189-331 and 361-409.

14. *In Psalmos Davidicos Commentarii*, PL 191, 55 A-1296 D; *Collectanea in omnes D. Pauli Apostoli Epistolas*, PL 191, 1297A-1696C and PL 192, 9 A-520 A. Brady provides detailed studies of these two works in his introduction to the *Sentences*, vol. I, 46*-93*.

15. Gerhoch, *Libellus de ordine donorum spiritus sancti*, Hahn, Hannover 1897 (MGH Libelli de Lite, 3), 275 «magnos magistros qui in suis glossis in Apostolum falsitatem inseruerunt... quorum praecipui sunt magistri Anshelmus et magister Gillibertus et novissime Petrus Longobardus»; cf. Brady, vol. I, 82*-84*.

ticular the *De doctrina Christiana* –, might suggest that he was simply a traditionalist in his perspective. Yet, as we shall see, Peter Lombard's rendering of the Trinity in the *Sentences* was no mere rehashing of Augustine. In fact, while loyal to broad themes of Augustine, Peter Lombard did not hesitate to recast with great subtlety certain opinions of the Bishop of Hippo. This recasting was not uninfluenced by his awareness of the arguments of Abelard.

Lombard opened his *Sentences* by discussing the semantic principles that Augustine had raised in the *De doctrina Christiana* about the distinction between *signa* and *res*: «All teaching concerns things or signs. With diligent investigation, we have pondered over and over again the contents of the Old and New Law; by God's prevenient grace, it has become clear to us that the study of the sacred page is principally concerned with things or with signs».[16] As if aware of the potential problems created for theology by Abelard's application of an Aristotelian *vox-res* antithesis to the Trinity, Lombard turned to Augustine for an alternative semantic theory. Lombard then moved to draw on Augustine's discussion in the *De doctrina Christiana* about the distinction between those realities which are to be used and those which are to be enjoyed. Although Augustine was not particularly concerned in that treatise with the Trinity, Peter Lombard seized on a passage about the divine essence as «a certain one supreme thing» (*una quaedam summa res*) to develop his argument. Initially, Lombard quoted this definition precisely: «The things therefore which are to be enjoyed, the Father, and Son and Holy Spirit, and the same Trinity, are one certain supreme thing, common to all who enjoy it, if indeed it is a thing, and not the cause of all things, if indeed it is the cause».[17] He quoted this and other passages from the *De doctrina*

16. Peter Lombard, *Sententiae*, I, d. 1, c. 1, ed. Brady, vol. I, 55 (trans. Silano, vol. I, 5), quoting *De doctrina Christiana* I, 2: «Omnis doctrina de rebus vel de signis. Ve-teris ac novae Legis continentiam diligenti indagine etiam atque etiam considerantibus nobis praevia Dei gratia innotuit sacrae paginae tractatum circa res vel signa praecipue versari».

17. Augustine, *De doctrina Christiana* I, 5, ed. J. Martin, *CCL* 32, Brepols, Turnhout 1962, 9; ed. W.M. Green, *CSEL* 80, Holder-Pichler-Tempsky, Vienna 1963, 10;

Christiana to support the distinction he wished to draw between use and true enjoyment (as distinct from simply using something or someone for personal delight) – in particular of the ultimate object of true enjoyment, namely God himself.

Yet, when Lombard turned to the philosophically contested question of the relationship between supreme reality and the terms Father, Son and Holy Spirit, he made an assertion that would strike Joachim of Fiore as outrageous: «In the same way it is not to be asserted that the divine essence generated the Son because, since the Son is the divine essence, the Son would already be the thing from which he is generated; and so the same thing would generate itself. And so also we say that the divine essence did not generate an essence. Since the divine essence is a one and supreme certain thing [reality], if the divine essence generated an essence, then the same thing generated itself, which is not at all possible. But the Father alone begot the Son, and the Holy Spirit proceeds from the Father and the Son».[18] Peter Lombard was emphasising a conceptual distinction between the supreme divine essence and the three persons, namely Father, Son, and Holy Spirit.

Joachim, as reported by the Council, had misquoted Peter Lombard by leaving out the crucial *una et* from Lombard's phrase, *una et summa quaedam res*, so as to reinforce the impression that Lombard was creating a fourth entity apart from the three divine persons. The critical edition of this passage in the *Sentences* does not identify that Lombard was here paraphrasing Augustine's de-

ed. M. Simonetti, Sant'Agostino, *L'istruzione cristiana*, Fondazione Lorenzo Valla, Mondadori, Milan 1994, 22-24: «res igitur, quibus fruendum est, pater et filius et spiritus sanctus eademque trinitas, una quaedam summa res communisque omnibus fruentibus ea, si tamen res et non rerum omnium causa, si tamen et causa». Quoted by Lombard, *Sent.* I, d. 1, c. 2, no. 4, ed. Brady, vol. I, 56; trans. Silano, vol. I, 6; also *Sent.* I, d. 25, c. 2, no. 5, ed. Brady, vol. I, 194; trans. Silano, vol. I, 137.

18. *Sent.* I, d. 5, c. 1, no. 6, ed. Brady, vol. I, 82: «Ita etiam non est dicendum quod diuina essentia genuit filium: Quia cum filius sit diuina essentia, iam esset filius res a qua generatur; et ita eadem res se ipsam generaret. Ita etiam dicimus quod essentia diuina non genuit essentiam: Cum enim una et summa quaedam res sit diuina essentia, si diuina essentia essentiam genuit, eadem res se ipsam genuit, quod omnino esse non potest: sed pater solus genuit filium, et a patre et filio procedit spiritus sanctus». Trans. Silano, vol. I, 31-32.

finition in the *De doctrina Christiana* about *una summa quaedam res* that he had quoted earlier, but with a very significant modification.[19] In fact, Lombard had silently paraphased Augustine's description of the Father, Son and Holy Spirit as three separate things, so as to reserve *res* uniquely for a single supreme divine essence, but not applying it to the relative terms *Father* and *Son*. Augustine had employed a traditional semantic theory, Stoic in origin, by which all words were signs of things (*res*), and had not been particularly troubled by referring to the individual divine persons as plural things or realities, when this might seem to challenge the notion of a single underlying divine essence. Lombard's subtle rephrasing of Augustine's comment suggests that he was very aware of the theological difficulty of Augustine having referred to both three persons as three things, and the divine essence as a thing. Lombard silently modified Augustine's definition in the *De doctrina Christiana* so as to distinguish the reality that was the divine essence from *Father, Son*, and *Holy Spirit* as relative terms that could not be identified with each other and were conceptually distinct from divine essence. This was a theological move of profound significance for the subsequent development of Trinitarian theology, so much of which would be built upon Peter Lombard's discussion in the *Sentences*.

Peter Lombard justified this crucial distinction by referring back to exactly the same passage at the opening of Augustine's *De trinitate* that Peter Abelard, years earlier, had himself quoted against Alberic of Reims, Lombard's own teacher. Abelard wanted to refute the claim that in his *Theologia* he was denying that God could beget God: «As for those who think that it is in God's power to generate himself, they err... For there is no reality at all which generates itself into existence».[20] While it is unlikely that he had read Abelard's

19. See above n. 17. Peter Lombard modified Augustine's text slightly, by changing *una quaedam summa res* to *una et summa quaedam res*; no variants to this phrase are recorded in the critical editions of either Augustine or Peter Lombard at this point.

20. Augustine, *De trinitate*, I, 1, ed. W.J. Mountain. *CCL* 50, Brepols, Turnhout 1968, 78: «qui autem putant eius esse potentiae deum ut seipsum ipse genuerit, eo plus errant quod non solum deus ita non est sed nec spiritalis nec corporalis crea-

account of this disputation in the *Historia Calamitatum*, Lombard certainly would have known Abelard's refutation of Alberic from the *Theologia 'Scholarium'*, a treatise originally directed against Roscelin of Compiègne's argument that each divine person had to signify a distinct reality (*res*) that could not be identified with each other.[21] Abelard's method, in philosophy as in theology, has been well described by Jean Jolivet as involving a process of *dereification* – a desire to separate language from the specific things that it might seem to signify.[22] Like Abelard, Peter Lombard focused attention on the terminology of Christian doctrine, and thus applied a similar methodology, even if the specific conclusions he reached were quite different.[23] For all his debt to Augustinian semantics, Peter Lombard subtly invoked a similar process to that of Abelard in refusing to describe the divine persons as separate realities. On the issue of whether divine essence could generate divine essence, Peter Lombard was in accord with Peter Abelard. To the question (*Sent.* I, d. 4, c. 1) «whether the Father generated a divine essence, or whether an essence generated the Son, or an essence generated an essence, or whether it neither generated nor was generated» his answer was firm: «neither did the Father generate a divine essence, nor did a divine essence generate the Son, nor did a divine essence generate an essence».[24] Lombard recognised that one had to distin-

tura. Nulla enim omnino res est quae se ipsam gignat ut sit». Quoted in *Sent.* I, d. 4, c. 1, ed. Brady, vol. I, 77-78; trans. Silano, I, 27; Abelard, *Historia calamitatum*, ed. J. Monfrin, Vrin, Paris 1978, 84-85.

21. Abelard, *Theologia 'Scholarium'*, II, 64 and 146, ed. E.-M. Buytaert and C.J. Mews, *CCM* 13, Brepols, Turnhout 1987, 440, 479; also quoted by Abelard *Sic et Non* 15, 1, ed. B.B. Boyer and R. McKeon, University of Chicago Press, Chicago 1977, 145; *Theologia 'Summi boni'* II, 62, ed. Buytaert-Mews, *CCM* 13, 134; *Theologia Christiana* III, 109, ed. Buytaert, *CCM* 12, Brepols, Turnhout 1969, 235.

22. Jean Jolivet, *Arts du langage et théologie chez Abélard*, Vrin, Paris 1969.

23. Alessandro Ghisalberti comments helpfully on Lombard's broad debt in this respect to Abelard's theological methodology, in *Auctoritas e inquisitio veritatis. Pietro Lombardo e l'evoluzione della teologia nel secolo XII*, in *Pietro Lombardo* (n. 1 above), 1-22, esp. 14-17. By contrast, John Marenbon (*Peter Abelard and Peter the Lombard*, in *Pietro Lombardo*, 225-239) emphasizes Lombard's failure to understand specifically philosophical themes in Abelard.

24. *Sent.* I, d. 5, c. 1, ed. Brady, vol. I, 80-81: «Post haec quaeritur utrum concedendum sit quod pater genuit divinam essentiam, uel quod divina essentia genuit

guish the relative terms *Father, Son* and *Holy Spirit*, from the underlying reality they signified. Unsurprisingly, not everyone agreed with him in making this distinction.

The passage in Augustine's *De doctrina Christiana* about the three divine persons as distinct realities (plural *res*), but as also constituting a supreme reality, was one that Roscelin of Compiègne had himself used, while Abelard would in turn quote it in his *Theologia Christiana* and *Sic et Non*.[25] In the *Sentences* Lombard quoted the passages of Augustine about one reality as unable to beget another reality, and about divine essence as a certain one supreme reality in exactly the same sequence as Abelard in the *Sic et Non*, suggesting that his reading of the Fathers had been powerfully shaped by Abelard's selection of pivotal patristic texts.[26] There was also an exceptionally close textual relationship between the quotation of patristic texts in Lombard's *Sentences* and in the *Theologia 'Scholarium'*, confirming the comment made by John of Cornwall that Peter Lombard always had Abelard's *Theologia* to hand.[27]

Peter Lombard's teachers and contemporaries

Lombard's careful distinction between the divine essence and the three divine persons suggests that on this particular issue, he shared Abelard's disagreement with Alberic of Reims, but does so without any sense of polemic. While Lombard clearly admired the theological vision of Hugh of St-Victor, he sought to extend it with the more precise armature of patristic learning and reasoned

filium, uel essentia genuit essentiam, an omnino non genuit nec genita est diuina essentia... Ideo non est dicendum quod pater genuit diuinam essentiam: Quia si pater diceretur genuisse diuinam essentiam, essentia diuina relatiue diceretur ad patrem uel pro relatiuo poneretur». Trans. Silano, vol. I, 30.

25. Abelard, *Sic et Non* 8, 28, ed. Boyer-McKeon, 133, and *Theologia Christiana* IV, 7, ed. Buytaert, 268.

26. The appendix of parallels between the *Sic et Non* and the *Sentences* of Lombard drawn up by Boyer and McKeon also shows that neither passage had been taken by Abelard from Ivo of Chartres, implying that it was Abelard who had first appreciated their significance; Abelard, *Sic et Non*, 635.

27. John of Cornwall, *Eulogium*, ed. Häring, 265 (n. 6 above).

discussion, in the fashion of the school of Laon and more critically of Abelard himself. In this way he could continue within the tradition established by Anselm of Laon and Alberic of Reims, but subtly absorbing from Abelard the importance of critical examination of patristic authority without giving overt attention to that of philosophical reason.

In doing so, Lombard was continuing a precedent already established in the *Summa sententiarum*, a succinct compendium of Hugh's teaching supplemented with significant patristic authorities as expounded by Anselm of Laon, but without Hugh's elegant literary style.[28] That another Italian, Otto of Lucca, was its author is confirmed by an unpublished *Introductio theologie* which includes two extracts from the *Summa Sententiarum* introduced initially as "from the sentences of master Anselm and master Hugh," and then as "from the treatise of master Otho according to master Anselm and master Hugh."[29] These rubrics are of great value be-

28. *Summa sententiarum*, *PL* 176, 41-174 and (under the name of Hildebert of Lavardin) *PL* 171, 1076-1150; Luscombe notes how it regularly criticises ideas of Abelard (*The School of Peter Abelard*, Cambridge University Press, Cambridge 1969, 198-213).

29. The *Introductio theologie* occurs in two manuscripts (E: Evreux, Bibl. Mun. 19, ff. 137r-145v and R: Rouen, Bibl. Mun. 553, ff. 134r-137rb). After a preface, it begins with excerpts from a sermon of Bernard of Clairvaux and from Peter Abelard's *Carmen ad Astralabium*, followed by excerpts from various authors, both patristic and modern: (E 138r R 134rb) «*Ex sententiis magistrorum a[nselmi] et h[ugonis]:* Melius enim est non eloqui magna, ubi sine periculo non erratur, quam difinire contraria. Sed ubicunque possumus auctoritatum uestigia imitemur, ut sint uera nostra autentica. Vbi uero deest auctoritas, his potissimum assentire studeamus; qui maxime auctoritatibus accedunt, et non de suo sensu presumentes, scripturas ex pietate interpretantur» (= *Summa Sententiarum*, Praefatio, *PL* 176, 41); (E 142r R 136rb) «*Ex tractatu magistri othonis iuxta magistrum ans[elmum] et M[agistrum] h[ugonem]:* Ratio approbat deum esse, et ita unum esse, ut principium omnium unum esset et finis. Si enim duo essent, uel utrumque insufficiens esset, uel alterum superfluum, quia si aliquid deesset alicui quod haberet aliud, non esset summe perfectum. Si uero uni nichil deesset quod haberet aliud, cum in uno omnia, alterum superflueret. Est ergo unum principium, unus auctor omnium. Igitur esse deum ratione caret qui contulit esse, effigiale manus, materiale lapis. Quod unus sit deus, multe auctoritates probant. Vt in propheta, *Audi Israel, deus tuus, deus unus est.* Et ideo uere unus est, quia incommunicabile, inuariabile. *Apud* eum namque *non est transmutatio, nec uicissitudinis obumbratio* quia non est ei aliud esse quam sapientem esse immensum, eter-

cause not only do they confirm Otto of Lucca as author of the *Summa Sententiarum*, but rightly identify the two major influences on that compilation.[30] Through the *Summa Sententiarum*, Peter Lombard absorbed teachings of both Anselm of Laon and Hugh of St-Victor, often critical of ideas being promoted by Peter Abelard.[31] Peter Lombard's theological synthesis was considerably more original, however, than that of the *Summa Sententiarum*. Drawing on both the *Summa Sententiarum* and the *Theologia 'Scholarium'*, his *Sentences* combined the textual precision of the key questions and patristic texts presented by Abelard with the clear dogmatic structure provided by Hugh of St-Victor.

One of the few surviving twelfth-century copies of the *Theologia 'Scholarium'* (Paris, Arsenal 265, not of high textual quality, but belonging to Saint-Victor), also contains a copy of the *Summa Sententiarum*, to which is appended a list of books borrowed from and sent to *magistro P. episcopo* by a certain Gaufridus Moricii, a servant

num, iustum, bonum. Cum autem dicitur iustus, sapiens et cetera, non diuersitatem proprietatum ostendimus, que in deo nulla est, sed diuersos effectus quos deus in creaturis operatur. Cum enim iustus dicitur: intelligimus quia iuste iudicat. Sapiens, quia sapienter omnia facit et gubernat. Misericors quando dicitur; intelligimus quia misericorditer peccatoribus parcit» (= *Summa Sententiarum* I, 4, *PL* 176, 47 D-48 A). I am indebted to Ralf Stammberger for supplying a transcription of these manuscripts. The compilation also includes a significant extract, not yet identified: E 141r R 135va «*Laurentius Dunelmensis*: Inuenies in eis nullum sine pondere uerbum... Quatuor autem regulas in his agnoscimus: Historiam, Allegoriam, Tropologiam, Anagogen. Historia est que res gestas loquitur». The fact that it is followed by an extract attributed to Hugh, suggests that this is master Lawrence from Durham (d. 1173) who transcribed Hugh's lectures in the 1130s as the *Sententie de divinitate* (ed. A.M. Piazzoni, «Studi Medievali», 23 [1982], 912-955). This Lawrence, not to be confused with the poet Lawrence of Durham (d. 1154), came to France on business in 1143, returning to Durham with him a letter from Bernard of Clairvaux (*Ep.* 543, ed. J. Leclercq, *Sancti Bernardi Opera*, vol. III Editiones Cisterciensis, Rome 1977, 510) and subsequently became abbot of Westminster. See E. Mason, «Lawrence (d. 1173), abbot of Westminster», *Oxford Dictionary of National Biography*, Oxford University Press, available online at http://www.oxforddnb.com/index.jsp

30. The case for the authorship of Otto of Lucca is put by F. Gastaldelli, *La 'Summa Sententiarum' di Ottone da Lucca. Conclusione di un dibattito secolare*, «Salesianum», 42 (1980), 537-546.

31. Luscombe, *The School of Peter Abelard*, 183-97.

and perhaps disciple of Peter Lombard.[32] The books borrowed from the bishop's library were of pagan authors, while the books Gaufridus brought to the bishop included many scriptural glosses. The fact that the only known copy of the revised version of John of Cornwall's *Eulogium*, also includes the *Summa Sententiarum* and the *Theologia 'Scholarium'* suggests that it might have included here to serve as a warning about how these treatises ought to be read at Saint-Victor.

During the two decades when Peter Lombard was establishing himself as a teacher at the cathedral school of Notre-Dame, his major rival among the secular masters teaching theology was Robert of Melun, an Englishman who taught logic on Mont Sainte-Geneviève in the mid 1130s before turning to theology under the influence of both Abelard and Hugh of St-Victor. Robert would continue to teach both dialectic and theology most likely at Sainte-Geneviève, until 1163, when he was appointed bishop of Hereford.[33] Whereas Lombard was always precise in his quotation of the Fathers and succinct in the formulation of key questions and a final response, Robert of Melun combined the ideas of Abelard and Hugh of St-Victor in emphasising the importance of the interior intention behind a text, rarely quoting them with any precision. In the polemical introduction to his vast two books of *Sentences*, concerned with ways of reading Scripture, Robert fulminated against "worshippers of the Gloss" and complained that too much theology was losing touch with the inspiration of Scripture.

32. Mews, *Introduction to Theologia 'Scholarium'*, *COCM* 13, 243-247. Patricia Stirnemann (*Histoire tripartite: un inventaire des livres de Pierre Lombard, un exemplaire de ses Sentences et le destinataire du Psautier de Copenhague*, in *Du copiste au collectionneur: mélanges d'histoire des textes et des bibliothèques en l'honneur d'André Vernet*, ed. J.-F. Genest and D. Nebbiai-Dalla Guarda, Brepols, Turnhout 1998, 301-319) rightly observes that Peter Lombard did not bequeath his books to St-Victor, as I mistakenly mentioned in that passage. Whether any of these books borrowed by or from Peter Lombard ever came to St-Victor is uncertain.

33. On Robert of Melun, see Mews, *Between the schools of Abelard and Saint-Victor in the mid twelfth century: the witness of Robert of Melun*, in *L'école de Saint-Victor de Paris. Influence et rayonnement du Moyen Âge à l'Époque moderne*, ed. D. Poirel, Brepols, Turnhout 2010, 121-134.

At the same time, he referred admiringly to two contemporary masters, one of whom spoke about the sacraments of faith (Hugh of St-Victor), the other about faith and charity (Abelard), whose teaching he had heard in person. Although Robert never identified his adversary by name, Lombard's close dependence on the Gloss suggests that he may have been Robert's target. Robert of Melun's two books of *Sentences*, compiled in the 1150s, contain much more overtly philosophical reflection on the nature of language than the four books of Peter Lombard, and consistently try to seek a synthesis between the perspectives of Abelard and Hugh of St-Victor. This work is so large and sprawling in its discussions, however, that it never acquired the popularity of Lombard's *Sentences*. It was simply too unwieldy as well as too imprecise in its citation of patristic references, to be useful within a pedagogical milieu.[34]

Peter Lombard and the beginnings of Christological controversy

That Lombard's teaching on Christology was already becoming controversial in the early 1150s is suggested by a report of a public debate by the Englishman, Robert of Cricklade.[35] Writing probably around 1158, Robert of Cricklade, an Augustinian canon from Oxford, recounted a journey he made to Paris. He wrote: « I remember that Roger, who is now Bishop of Worcester, came to our inn. I asked him with whom he was studying theology, and he replied, "With Master Robert of Melun." "I am very pleased," I said, "as I feared that you had been ensnared by that heretic

34. Less than half of Robert's *Sententie* has been edited by R.-M. Martin, *Œuvres de Robert of Melun*, 3 vols, Spicilegium Sacrum Lovaniense, Louvain 1932-1952, in particular vol. III, 1 (1947) and (with R.M. Gallet), vol. III, 2 (1952); see also M. Perkams, *Robert von Melun und die Rezeption der Abaelardischen Ethik im 12. Jahrhundert. Nebst einer kritischen Edition von Robert von Melun, Sententiae, I, II, [o], 164-171 und I, I, 8, 79-84*, « Recherches de théologie et philosophie médiévales », 75.1 (2008), 33-76.

35. R.W. Hunt, *English Learning in the late Twelfth Century*, « Transactions of the Royal Historical Society », 4th ser., 19 (1936), 19–42, esp. 32; on the likelihood of a date around 1151, see D.M. Coulter, *Per Visibilia ad Invisibilia. Theological Method in Richard of St. Victor (d. 1173)*, Brepols, Turnhout 2006, 247.

[Peter Lombard]" ».[36] Roger asked Robert Cricklade to explain the ways in which Peter Lombard could be said to be a heretic. Robert recalled that he told Roger that Peter Lombard « separates man from God, so that he is not one human person with God in the Trinity, who is really the Son of God. »[37] These intriguing comments, emerging from an Englishman who had only recently arrived in Paris, demonstrate something of the degree to which academic gossip about error and heresy spread among educated circles in Europe. National rivalries may have exacerbated such rumour-mongering. Peter Lombard was an Italian, teaching at Notre-Dame, while Robert of Melun attracted English disciples, like Robert of Cricklade, Roger of Worcester, and John of Cornwall. Achard, Richard and Walter of St-Victor are similarly all reported as of English background.[38]

Robert's allegation that Peter Lombard « separates man from God, so that he is not one human person with God in the Trinity » summarised crudely the charges made against him in the years following the publication of the *Sentences*. The allegations that would plague the reputation of Peter Lombard over the second half of the twelfth century crystallized around his discussion of Christology in the third book of the *Sentences*. He was accused of minimising Christ's humanity to the point that it could be considered a *nihil*, hence the charge that he was guilty of nihilianism. There has been much debate about whether or not Lombard was

36. Robert Cricklade, *Symbolum fidei*, in Hunt, *English Learning in the Late Twelfth Century*, 37: « Meminit enim me domnum Rogerum, qui nunc est Wigornensis episcopus, venisse ad hospicium nostrum. Quem cum interrogassem apud quem in divina pagina studeret, et respondisset, "Apud magistrum Robertum Meldunensem." "Perplacet," inquam "timebam enim, ne te teneret inviscatum hereticus ille" ».

37. Robert Cricklade, *Symbolum fidei*, ed. Hunt, 37-38: « Separat, inquam, hominem a Deo, ut non sit una persona homo Deo in trinitate, qui revera filius Dei est ».

38. See H. Platelle, *Gautier de Saint-Victor*, in *Dictionnaire d'Histoire et de Géographie Ecclésiastiques*, 20, Letouzey et Ané, Paris 1984, col. 111. Achard was remembered in an epitaph at Saint-Victor as *Anglorum gloria cleri*. On Achard, see J. Châtillon, *Théologie, spiritualité et métaphysique dans l'oeuvre oratoire d'Achard de Saint-Victor*, Vrin, Paris 1968.

actually guilty of Christological nihilianism, as his critics claimed. In this section of the *Sentences*, Peter Lombard was keen to delineate the various theories of the nature of the hypostasis, in particular to understand how Christ could be one person, with two natures, following the Council of Chalcedon. Christ was one person, but with divine and human natures. This was difficult to explain, since to have a human nature was to preclude a divine one. To be human was, precisely, not to be divine. Therefore, Lombard was moved to ask «Whether Christ, according to his being a man, is a person or anything».[39] In his view, Christ as a man was not a divine person, although he was something. As a divine person, he was not a particular thing. This particular section of his *Sentences* led to repeated claims that he had undermined the reality of Christ's humanity, and therefore propounded a problematic Christology. That Peter Lombard had composed this issue in the terms of an open-ended question, rather than a final statement did not appease his critics. As we shall see, they felt that even the raising of the issue was tantamount to heresy. It permitted abstractions that resulted in error.

In the early 1160s Gerhoch of Reichersberg continued his campaign against Peter Lombard. In 1164 Gerhoch sent Pope Alexander III a letter urging him to denounce Peter Lombard and promote ecclesiastical reform.[40] Gerhoch's concern about the Christological arguments raised in the third book of *Sentences* was exacerbated by the enthusiasm being shown for it in monastic circles. The work was copied at Clairvaux at an early date, and was circulating both in cathedral libraries and in monastic houses in Bavaria by 1165. An early copy of the *Sentences* in Salzburg includes a short poem celebrating Abelard.[41] The Pope's reply to Gerhoch's provocation was

39. *Sent.* III, d. 10, c. 1, ed. Brady, vol. II, 72: «An Christus secundum quod homo est sit persona vel aliquid». Trans. Silano, vol. III, 41.

40. Gerhoch of Reichersberg, *Ep. 17 ad Alexandrum III papam*, *PL* 193, 564B-570A.

41. Salzburg, Stiftsbibliothek Sankt Peter MS a.XI.5, p. 1 (s. xii). This epitaph (repr. in *PL* 178, 103D-104A) also occurs in Vienna, Österreichische Nationalbibliothek, 1627 (s. xiii), identical in contents and probably also from Salzburg; see J. Barrow, C. Burnett and D.E. Luscombe, *A Checklist of the manuscripts containing the writings of Peter Abelard and Heloise and other works closely associated with Abelard and his school*, «Revue d'histoire des textes», 14-15 (1984-1985), 183-302, nos. 169, 448. Early monastic copies of Peter Lombard's writing came to the possession of Admont, Stiftsbibliothek MSS 52 and 125 (*Comm. in Epistolas Pauli*) and MSS 286 and 364 (*Libri Sententiarum*). Wolfger mentions Peter Lombard as one of many modern masters; Chr. E. Ineichen-Eder, *Bistümer Passau und Regensburg*, Mittelalterliche Bibliothekskataloge Deutschlands und der Schweiz, 4.1, C.H. Beck, Munich 1977, 422 and 427; See Mews, *Scholastic Theology in a Monastic Milieu in the Twelfth Century: the case of Admont*, in *Manuscripts and Monastic Culture: Religious Reform and Intellectual Life in Twelfth-Century Germany*, ed. A. Beach, Brepols, Turnhout 2007, 217-239, n. 32; Troyes, Bibl. Mun. 286 was copied at Clairvaux soon after 1160.

swift and brusque. In two letters expedited together from Sens on the 22nd of March 1164 – one addressed to Gerhoch and the other to Eberhard, Archbishop of Salzburg, and delivered by the same courier – the Pope wrote «to persuade and put upon Provost Gerhoch of Reichersberg to be silent about certain aspects of faith under disputation».[42] The Pope's instruction of silence, however clearly had little effect in silencing the controversy. The *Annales Reichersperganses* recorded that in December 1164, at a meeting convened at Sens with several lettered men, Alexander extended the restriction he imposed upon Gerhoch. It claimed that the Pope expressly «condemned and prohibited all tropes and undisciplined questions in theology» and requested that the Bishop of Paris, Maurice de Sully, enforce this restriction throughout France.[43]

The Pope's letter evinced a concern about the effects of hearsay and rumour upon reputations of theology and theologians. This concern was perhaps warranted. Peter Lombard's disciple Bandinus composed an abbreviation of the *Sentences* more outspoken in its treatment of Christology, and criticism of perspectives, deriv-

42. Alexander III, *Ep. 242 Ad Eberhardum*, *PL* 200, 287C-289B; *Ep. 243 Ad Gerhohum*, *PL* 200, 289B-290A. On these letters, see P. Jaffé, *Regesta pontificum Romanorum ab condita ecclesia ad annum post Christum natum MCXCVIII*, repr. Akademischer Druck- und Verlagsanstalt, Graz 1956, nos. 11011-11012.

43. *Annales Reichersperganses* in *MGH* 17, 471: «Ipso anno ... Alexander papa convocatis in unum scholasticis et quibusque litteratis in ipsa vigilia nativitatis Domini... condemnavit et omnino interdixit omnes tropos et indisciplinatis questiones in theologia, Parisiensique episcopo sub obedientia praecepuit, ut per totam Franciam eas compesceret. Sententia autem de gloria hominis in Deum assumpti et in Deum nati approbata est ibi coram papa ac roborata...».

ing from the school of Anselm of Laon. The fact that Vacarius, an Italian lawyer resident in England, who may have engaged in debate with Bandinus in the course of travelling to northern France in 1164, would write his own treatise *de homine assumpto*, asserting the reality of Christ as a human being assumed by God, suggests that it may have been Lombard's disciples rather than Lombard himself who projected views that seemed to challenge authority.[44] Gerhoch was much bolder, however, in asserting that Lombard himself was the source of error.

Peter Lombard and his critics

During the first half of the twelfth century, the major theological competition within Paris had been between the schools associated with the abbeys of Sainte-Geneviève and St-Victor. This rivalry would subside in 1147, when, following the death of the dean of Sainte-Geneviève, Stephen of Garlande, the abbey was taken over by canons of St-Victor. The success of Peter Lombard at the cathedral school of Notre-Dame, however, may have created stronger rivalry between Notre-Dame and the schools of the left bank during the 1150s. The cathedral and its school would became even more prominent in Paris after Peter Lombard's successor, Maurice de Sully (bishop of Paris from 1160 to 1196), initiated its rebuilding in the new Gothic style. This had the potential to reinforce rivalry between the cathedral and Saint-Victor, the building of which had started during the first half of the twelfth century.

Paradoxically, Maurice de Sully was, prior to becoming bishop, among those who had accused Peter Lombard of espousing heretical views in Christology. John of Cornwall reports that he had been turned away from following Peter Lombard during lectures

44. Vacarius, *De homine assumpto*, ed. N. Häring, «Med. Stud.», 21 (1959). 147-175; see J. Taliadoros, *Law and Theology in the Twelfth Century*, Brepols, Turnhout 2006, and in more detail, *The Lombard, Bandinus, and Vacarius: Christological Nihilianism and the Anglo-Norman Realm*, in *Mind Matters: Studies on Medieval and Early Modern Intellectual History in Honor of Marcia Colish*, ed. C. J. Nederman, N. Van Deusen and E. Ann Matter, Brepols, Turnhout 2009, 133-156.

of Maurice and Robert of Melun.[45] John also quotes from the *De trinitate* of Achard, who succeeded to Gilduin as abbot of St-Victor from 1155 to 1162 (when he was appointed bishop of the Norman see of Avranches).[46] In theologically sophisticated sermons, Achard took issue with the view linked with Lombard: «There are still certain enemies of truth who say that when the Word was made man, he was not made anything, nor in that which he is a man is he something which we are».[47] Achard was no opponent of theological innovation, being a speculative thinker of a high order, fascinated by Platonic themes and arguments from reason. In his work on the Trinity, for example, he was fascinated by the notion of the divine substance generating an uncreated plurality of essences, out of which the Trinity could be perceived.[48] These remarks show his concern about the effect of dialectical reasoning upon the definition of doctrine, if it threatened to limit understanding of the outpouring of divine essence in the persons of the Godhead.

Achard was also a major influence on Richard, another Englishman who came to St-Victor probably around 1145, rising to be-

45. John of Cornwall, *Eulogium*, ed. Häring, 268: «Duos etiam venerabiles magistros quos in theologia certissimum est nichil hereticum docuisse, Robertum scilicet Melodinensem et Mauricium hodie Parisiensem episcopum, silentio preterire non debeo. Eorum utique super hiis questionibus scripta non legi, sed multis eorum lectionibus et disputationibus interfui, in quibus et de homine assumpto et de hiis quibusdam magistri Petri Lumbardi doctrinam falsitatis arguebant, ne dicam erroris».

46. John of Cornwall, *Eulogium*, ed. Häring, 268. On Richard of St-Victor, see Coulter, *Per Visibilia ad Invisibilia*; on Maurice de Sully, see J. Longère, *Œuvres oratoires de maîtres parisiens au XIIe siècle. Etude historique et doctrinale*, Institut d'études augustiniennes, Paris 1975, and Id., *Les sermons latins de Maurice de Sully, évêque de Paris (1196): contribution à l'histoire de la tradition manuscrite*, Kluwer Academic Publishers, Dordrecht 1988. The close sympathy of Maurice de Sully as bishop for St-Victor is observed by Chr. Gut, *Les actes de Maurice de Sully relatifs aux possessions parisiennes de Saint-Victor (1180-1196)*, in *Huitième centenaire de Notre-Dame de Paris*, 35-52.

47. Achard de Saint-Victor, *Sermons inédits*, ed. J. Châtillon, Vrin, Paris 1970, 61-62: «Sunt adhuc quidam inimici veritatis qui dicunt quod quando Verbum factum est homo, non est factum aliquid, nec in eo quod est homo est aliquid quod nos sumus». See Châtillon, *Théologie spiritualité et métaphysique*, 203-206.

48. Châtillon, *Théologie spiritualité et métaphysique*, 302-312; See M.-Th. d'Alverny, *Achard de Saint-Victor: De Trinitate-De unitate et pluralitate creaturarum*, «Rech. Théol. Anc. Méd.», 2 (1954), 229-306.

come subprior in 1158, and then prior from 1162 until his death in 1172. Although Richard never engaged in extreme polemic in the fashion of his successor as prior, Walter of St-Victor, his intellectual influence in questioning Peter Lombard's presentation of the Trinity should not be underestimated. Richard never composed any book of sentences. He preferred to compose treatises that had a contemplative goal, tracing the mystical connections between the Old and New Testaments (including the book of Revelation), while also arguing that the mind could be led through rational argument about the visible world to an invisible realm of reflection. In his speculative masterpiece, the *De Trinitate* (a work that survives in over fifty manuscripts), he reflected on the Godhead as an outpouring of supreme love manifest through each of the three persons. Unlike Peter Lombard, Richard never quoted explicitly from the Fathers of the Church, but rather followed Achard and St Anselm (an author never quoted by Peter Lombard), in seeking to develop a wholly rational reflection on the nature of supreme substance, arguing «from experience, ratiocination and belief».[49] He had a particular fondness for inventing abstract terms like *substantialitas* to invoke what is general to specific species and *Danielitas* the specific reality of an individual, called Daniel.[50] Richard drew on St Anselm to argue for the importance of intellectual understanding arising from faith in a supreme good that manifest as power, wisdom and goodness, manifest as Father, Son and Holy Spirit.

Whereas Augustine had favoured comparing the Trinity to memory, intellect and will within the soul of a single person, Richard of St-Victor extended Achard's idea that divine love requires that there should be a plurality of persons. He devoted much philosophical discussion to the difference between substance and person without ever referring explicitly to Aristotle. Richard's argument that charity requires that love extended to a

49. Richard of St. Victor, *De trinitate*, I, 1, ed. J. Ribaillier, Vrin, Paris 1958, 86: «Rerum notitiam, ni fallor, modo triplici apprehendimus: nam alia experiendo probamus, alia ratiocinando colligimus, aliorum certitudinem credendo tenemus».

50. Richard of St. Victor, *De trinitate*, II, 12, ed. Ribaillier, 118-119.

plurality of persons drew on the same passage of Gregory the Great as Abelard had used in the *Theologia* to argue that the Holy Spirit, as charity, had to exist between two persons.[51] This is philosophical theology of a high order of abstraction, modelled on the authority of St Anselm rather than of Peter Lombard. He insisted that reason demanded a trinity of persons in God, but excluded any quaternity.[52] By looking at the divine nature as *caritas* seeking plurality, he created a very different vision of the Trinity from that presented by Peter Lombard, who used Augustine's definition in the *De doctrina Christiana* to perform a type of category analysi.[53] Richard was more keen to articulate the mystical connections that bound sacred persons together.

In the sixth and final book of the *De trinitate*, Richard reflected on the profound kinship (*germanitas*) between parent and child as a model for understanding the nature of the relationship between the three persons of the Trinity. After concluding that power, wisdom, and goodness are to be attributed to the Father, Son and Holy Spirit respectively, he engaged in the only polemical section within the whole work, a diatribe against those who argue that substance cannot beget substance, referring explicitly to *vestra expositio*, certainly an allusion to Lombard's *Sentences*: «But many in our time have arisen who do not dare to say this, or rather, what is much more dangerous, they dare to deny against the authority of the holy Fathers and so many assertions of patristic tradition, and

51. Richard of St. Victor, *De trinitate*, III, 2, ed. Ribaillier, 136: «Oportet itaque ut amor *in alterum tendat ut caritas esse* queat. Ubi ergo pluralitas personarum deest, caritas omnino esse non potest». Cf. Abelard, *Theologia 'Scholarium'*, II, 123, ed. Buytaert-Mews, 469: «Caritas autem, teste Gregorio, minus quam inter duos haberi non potest. Nemo enim, inquit, ad semetipsum habere caritatem proprie dicitur, sed dilectione si in alterum extendit ut esse caritas possit». The reference is to Gregory, *Hom. in Evangelia* I, hom. 17, *PL* 76, 1139 B.

52. Richard of St. Victor, *De trinitate*, V, 14-15, 21, ed. Ribaillier, 212-214, 219.

53. J. Bligh presents the contrast between Augustine's psychological and Richard's social analysis of the Trinity, and suggests that Richard may have been influenced in this by Abelard, *Richard of St-Victor's De Trinitate: Augustinian or Abelardian?* «Heythrop Journal», I (1960), 118-139. D.E. Luscombe is more reserved about Abelard's influence, *The School of Peter Abelard*, 303-304.

they try to refute in every way. They do not concede in any way that substance begets substance, or wisdom wisdom. They stubbornly deny what all the saints affirm.... Your exposition strives to this, that we believe that substance does not beget substance. The faithful exposition, worthy of full acceptance, asserts that what the holy Fathers equally assert, is false, and contends that what none of the saints assert is true. But they say: "If the substance of the Son is begotten, that of the Father is unbegotten, how can there be one and the same substance of both?"».[54] This was an issue of great importance to Richard,. Given that this is precisely the claim made by Peter Lombard at the outset of his *Sentences*, that substance does not beget substance, there can be little doubt that Richard was consciously challenging the arguments that Lombard had held, most likely during the 1160s.[55]

The campaign against Lombard's Christology

While Richard of St-Victor was quite original in raising criticisms of Peter Lombard's Trinitarian theology in his *De trinitate*, most of the public controversy centred around his Christological ideas – accusations that were always very difficult to substantiate. Lombard's Christology was debated in the Pope's presence at Tours in May 1163 and again in December 1164 at Sens.[56] While the pope reportedly put Maurice de Sully under particular pressure to prohibit undisciplined theological debate about the nature of Christ, the official proceedings of both councils did not record any official judgment against Lombard.[57] Yet in 1170, the Pope was explicit in instructing William, Archbishop of Sens, and his suffragans to halt the spread of Lombard's teaching: « When you were once in our presence, we enjoined you verbally that you explicitly urge and effectively summon your suffragans who are associated with you at Paris, to renounce the vicious doctrine of Peter, erstwhile bishop of Paris, in which it is said that Christ, according to his being a man, is not anything ».[58] Alexander also warned William that he was « imposing this firmly and distinctly to all, that anyone who should presume to teach this doctrine among others shall be solemnly denounced (*detestentur*) ».[59] *Detestor* is a strong word here, having both religious and legal meanings, respectively, to be cursed and abominated, or, to be renounced under oath. It has been argued that this statement hinted that Alexander was planning to put the issue on the agenda at Lateran III, proclaimed in 1177.[60] In early 1177 Alexander wrote again to William, who was now at Reims, strengthening the earlier injunction, anathematizing anyone who promulgated the formula *Christus secundum quod est homo, non est aliquid*.[61]

54. Richard of St. Victor, *De trinitate*, VI, 22, ed. Ribaillier, 259-260: «Sed multi temporibus nostris surrexere qui non audent hoc dicere, quin potius, quod multo periculosius est, contra sanctorum Patrum auctoritatem et tot attestationes paternarum traditionum audent negare et modis omnibus conantur refellere. Nullo modo concedunt quod substantia gignat substantiam, vel sapientia sapientiam. Pertinaciter negant quod omnes sancti affirmant; ... vestra expositio ad hoc contendit, ut credamus quod substantia substantiam non gignit. Fidelis expositio et omni acceptione digna, que hoc quod sancti Patres pariter clamant contendit esse falsum, et quod nemo sanctorum asserit contendit esse verum! Sed dicunt: "Si Filii substantia est genita, Patris vero ingenita, quomodo utriusque erit una eadem substantia?"».

55. Ribaillier, introduction to Richard of St. Victor, *De trinitate*, 11-12.

56. J. Châtillon, *Latran III et l'enseignement christologique de Pierre Lombard*, in *Le troisième concile de Latran (1179). Sa place dans l'histoire*, ed. J. Longère, Etudes Augustiniennes, Paris 1982, 75-90, esp. 77-82.

57. See above n. 42.

58. Alexander III, *Ep. 744 Willelmo*, *PL* 200, 685 B; also in *Chartularium Universitatis Parisiensis*, ed. H. Denifle, vol. I, Paris 1889, 4; Jaffe-Wattenbach, *Regesta Pontificum Romanorum*, vol. II, no. 11806: « Cum in nostra olim esses praesentia constitutus, tibi viva voce injunximus, ut suffraganeis tuis Parisius tibi ascitis ad abrogationem pravae doctrinae Petri quondam Parisiensis episcopi, qua dicitur quod Christus secundum quod est homo non est ... ». In the version printed as *Ep. 743* of Pope Alexander, *PL* 200, 685 BC, the words *Petri quondam Parisiensis episcopi* are omitted.

59. Alexander III, *Ep. 744 Willelmo*, *PL* 200, 685 C: « universis firmiter et distincte injungens, quod doctrinam illam de caetero nequaquam docere praesumant, sed ipsam penitus detestentur ».

60. Colish, *Peter Lombard*, 429.

61. Denifle, *Chartularium Universitatis Parisiensis*, I, 8-9: « Cum Christus perfectus Deus sit homo, mirum est, qua temeritate quisdam audet dicere, quod Christus non sit aliquid secundum quod homo. Ne autem tanta possit in ecclesia Dei abusio subrepere vel error induci, fraternitati tue per apostolica scripta mandamus, quatinus convocatis magistris scolarum Parisiensium et Remensium et aliarum circumpositarum civitatum auctoritate nostra sub anathemate interdicas, ne quis de cetero

On the eve of the III Lateran Council, held in 1179, John of Cornwall would remind the Pope of his 1170 ruling within a treatise, urging him to act again against ideas that were continuing to hold sway in the Parisian schools.[62] He wrote a letter to Alexander «since, with many scholars inebriated from this chalice [of error], they turn around, up until this day, and stubbornly abuse your patience with this madness, those who by no means praise the pious dispensation of your mercy, but preach an irreverent dogma as if were catholic»."[63] He petitioned the Pope to include the matter of Christology on the agenda for the council so that the matter can be resolved once and for all. His reasons for doing so, according to the text, was that he wanted to save the reputation of Peter Lombard from those who conflated him with his followers. John wrote: «A little before he was elected Bishop of Paris, I heard Peter Lombard protest to me and to others present, that he had not asserted his own opinion, but only that which he had received from masters... Since then certain men more chatty than wise who ought not even have been heard in a bedroom, have preached [Christological error] from the rooftops, right up until today».[64] It would seem that the success of the *Sentences* as a textbook had produced, in the eyes of many, excessively noisy speculation on all manner of sacred things.

Walter of St-Victor composed an even more polemical treatise, *Contra quatuor labyrinthos Franciae*, that identified both Lombard

dicere audeat Christum non esse aliquid secundum quod homo, quia sicut verus Deus ita verus est homo ex anima racionali et humana carne subsistens».

62. John of Cornwall, *Eulogium*; see also E. Rathbone, *John of Cornwall: a brief biography*, «Rech. Théol. Anc. Méd.», 17 (1950), 46–60.

63. John of Cornwall, *Eulogium*, ed. Häring, 258: «Quoniam itaque infiniti scolares hoc calice debriati et in furorem uersi usque in hodiernum patientia vestra contumaciter abutuntur, qui nequaquam misericordie vestre piam dispensationem laudant sed impium dogma uelud catholicum predicant».

64. John of Cornwall, *Eulogium*, ed. Häring, 265: «Preterea paulo ante quam electus esset in episcopum Parisiensem, michi et omnibus auditoribus suis qui tunc aderant protestatus est, quod hoc non esset assertio sua sed opinio sola, quam a magistris acceperat. ... Postea uero per quosdam homines loquaces magis quam perspicaces que nec in cubiculis essent audienda usque hodie predicantur super tecta».

and Peter of Poitiers (described as provost of the schools of Peter Comestor), as just as serious threats to orthodoxy as Peter Abelard and Gilbert of Poitiers.[65] It constituted a crude attack upon the intellectual rivals of the Victorines, past and present.[66] The treatise was a scathing invective that described the four labyrinths, Abelard, Gilbert of Poitiers, Peter of Poitiers and Peter Lombard, as having «the loquacity of putrid frogs» and being «poisoned on the spirit of Aristotle».[67] Walter's purpose in writing the work, was to keep the issue of Peter Lombard's Christology alive since, in spite of John of Cornwall's efforts, Alexander had decided to leave off the issue at Lateran III. Whether or not he was himself present at the Council, Walter argued that the Pope had wanted to condemn Lombard at this Council, but that he encountered resistance from his Cardinals: «Pope Alexander recently prepared to condemn by name his [Peter Lombard's] *Sententiae* at the Roman Council by which.. that diabolical error of the new heretics has erupted again, that in as much as Christ is a man, he is nothing (*nichil*)».[68] Apparently, one of the cardinals present (Adam of St Asaph, formerly provost of the schools of Peter Lombard), complained to the Pope, «Lord, let us undertake to consider more

65. See above n. 6.

66. P. Glorieux, *Mauvaise action et mauvais travail. Le Contra quatuor labyrinthos Franciae de Gauthier de Saint-Victor*, «Rech. Théol. Anc. Méd.», 21 (1954), 179-193. See now the close study of Walter's treatise by Rossi, *Contra Lombardum* in *Pietro Lombardo*, 128-144 (n. 1 above).

67. *Le Contra quatuor labyrinthos Franciae de Gauthier de Saint-Victor*, ed. Glorieux, 201: «putride ranarum garrulitates ... uno aristotilico spiritu afflatos».

68. *Le Contra quatuor labyrinthos Franciae de Gauthier de Saint-Victor*, ed. Glorieux, 201: «Hoc etiam sciendum quod Alexander papa nuper in concilio romano paraverat nominatim illius sententias damnare quarum argumentis etiam Arii et Sabellii et novorum hereticorum error diabolicus recrudescit, scilicet quod Christus nichil sit secundum quod homo. Quidam uero cardinalium causam Dei et fidei christiane religionis qua stamus et uiuimus, alienis negociis potponentes, non recte respondentes dixerunt uenerabili pape : Domine, alia maiora suscepimus tractanda. Tunc apostolicus : Immo primum et maximum de fide et hereticis agendum est. Quod illi audientes egressi sunt de consistorio. Quidam etiam episcopus, Adam walensis exiuit cum illis dicens : Domine papa, ego et clericus et prepositus olim scolarum eius, defendam sententias magistri».

serious issues», to which the Pope replied, «On the contrary, first we must deal with faith and with heretics.» Walter presented the diabolical error as having evidently infected the cardinals with whom Alexander was meeting. Nonetheless, there is no official record from Lateran III recording Lombard's condemnation, suggesting that his supporters did in fact achieve a silent victory, leaving his critics troubled by the extent of his influence.

Walter's work was highly provocative in its doctrinal recasting. The Christological statement that had already concerned the Pope and John of Cornwall was the discussion «Whether Christ, according to his being a man, is a person or anything (*non est aliquid*)». Walter, however, said that Peter Lombard and his followers had argued «that in as much as Christ is a man, he is nothing (*nichil*)». The use of *aliquid*, although very problematic, was less problematic than Walter's formulation. The ambivalence of the *aliquid* implied that Christ, in his fullness, was not a composite being in the way that humans are composite beings. Walter's turn to *nichil* lost that nuance, and accused Peter Lombard of denying Christ's humanity altogether. Walter's semantic recasting, albeit crude and sloppy, was pointed. It made literal what that Christological formula had been accused of doing, rendering Christ's humanity into nothing, and therefore promulgating heresy.

In raising issues about Lombard's Christology, both John of Cornwall and Walter of Saint-Victor were creating an atmosphere of polemical argument very different from the abstract theological concerns of Richard of Saint-Victor. In spite of the pressure placed upon Alexander III by John and Walter for a public discussion of these issues, the Pope was resistant to a public trial of the sort that had been seen with Abelard and Gilbert of Poitiers. While the Pope was prepared to issue strong interdicts in writing, there is no record of his assuming a public judicial posture regarding these issues. Consequently, the opportunity for adversarial drama became more limited, the creation of combative personas was less encouraged. It is much harder to write a narrative of winners and losers without the battles. The quarrels seem to end with whimpers rather than bangs. The Christological ideas attributed to Peter Lombard by John and Walter continued

to be debated in the schools, but did not generate further polemical treatises.[69]

By contrast, the theological argument raised in the conclusion of Richard of St-Victor's *De trinitate* was of a different order. Richard was fully familiar with speculative argument in theology, but insisted on defining God not as a *summa quaedam res* but as overflowing divine love, mediated directly through the persons of the Trinity. Like so many of his contemporaries, Richard drew elements of his thinking from both Abelard and Hugh of St-Victor. Yet for all his fascination with abstract forms, his driving argument was that God's divine nature was mediated fully and directly through Father, Son and Holy Spirit. Richard's vigorous refutation in the *De trinitate* of those who denied that substance generated substance in the Trinity, was a much more serious argument than any polemical claim made by John of Cornwall and Walter of St-Victor in relation to Lombard's Christology. It was one that would be followed up in more detail by Joachim of Fiore.

Joachim of Fiore and Peter Lombard

Whether Joachim was present at the III Lateran Council in 1179, and thus learned at first hand about the tension reported by Walter of Saint-Victor between disciples of Peter Lombard, like Cardinal Adam, and his critics, or had seen Walter's polemical treatise, is not certain. Even if he may not have known Geoffrey of Auxerre, forced to resign as abbot of Clairvaux in 1165, when he became abbot of Fossanova (1170-76) and subsequently an adver-

69. M. Colish provides the most exhaustive summary of the issue in her *Christological Nihilism in the Second Half of the Twelfth Century*, «Rech. Théol. Anc. Méd.», 63 (1996), 146-155. In this article Colish argues that while the Lombard always remained cautious in his Christology, a number of his supporters were not so. She assumes that this is because they misunderstood the orthodoxy of Peter Lombard's *Sententiae*. She wrote the article primarily in response to Lauge Olaf Nielsen, *Theology and Philosophy in the Twelfth Century: A Study of Gilbert Porreta's Thinking and the Theological Expositions of the Doctrine of the Incarnation in the Period 1130-1180*, Brill, Leiden 1982, 264-361. In this work Nielsen argued that Peter Lombard had a coherent school who consistently proposed the *habitus* theory after the death of their master.

sary, Joachim was actively engaged at the time of the Council in seeking to affiliate his abbey at Corazzo to the Cistercian Order.[70] He was then immersing himself in the writings of Bernard of Clairvaux, whose prophetic style he wished to emulate, although with an exegetical approach that was his own.

The only passage in which Joachim is known to explicitly castigate Lombard by name occurs in his *De vita sancti Benedicti*, written in 1186, within a passage that contrasts how monastic liturgy can teach the triune nature of God through using three readings in the night office in winter, but only one in summer, with the impious instruction offered by Sabellius, Arius, and «the blasphemy of Peter, who by dividing the unity from the Trinity introduced quaternity».[71] Joachim's treatise explained how Benedict ushered in the age of the Spirit, prefigured in the Old Testament, and how the Cistercians renewed this spirit after a long period of corruption within the monastic order. He believed that the monastic life gave better instruction in the mystery of the Trinity than any scholastic in Paris. His was a prophetic voice, sharply critical of the worldliness of the Church and convinced that reformed monasticism could not merely understand, but actually enact the mission of the Holy Spirit.

Whether the treatise condemned in 1215 is a lost work of Joachim, explicitly directed against Lombard's theology, or rather Joachim's first major work on the Trinity, the *Psalterium decem chordarum* (in which there is criticism of the notion of quaternity, but Lombard is not himself named in person), begun around 1183-84 is not completely certain. Joachim seems to have revised the *Psalterium*, between 1194-96 and 1200, when it received its present title.[72] Possi-

70. F. Gastaldelli, *Goffredo di Auxerre e Gioacchino da Fiore. Testi e personaggi a confronto*, first published in 1988, reprinted in Id., *Studi su san Bernardo e Goffredo di Auxerre*, Sismel - Edizioni del Galluzzo, Florence 2001, 375-422.

71. Ioachim abbas Florensis, *Tractatus in expositionem vite et regule beati Benedicti*, III, 2, ed. A. Patschovsky, Istituto Storico Italiano per il Medio Evo, Roma 2008 (Fonti per la storia dell'Italia medievale. Antiquitates, 29), 208: «tertio blasphemia Petri, qui unitatem a Trinitate dividens quaternitatem inducit».

72. Gian Luca Potestà has revived the possibility that the text condemned in 1215 is Joachim's *Psalterium decem chordarum*, in *Joachim de Flore dans la recherche actuelle*,

bly the Council was condemning an earlier version of the work, in which Joachim had been more explicitly critical of Peter Lombard. Joachim's criticisms related not to Peter Lombard's Christology, but to his very specific understanding of the Trinity, substantiated through a specific passage of the first book of the *Sentences*. The abbot of Fiore criticised any attempt to separate the divine essence from the three persons.[73] At the outset of his *Psalterium decem chordarum*, Joachim asserted that the three divine persons share fully in the divine substance. He rejected the perfidy of those who introduced a quaternity into God.[74] Towards the end of that treatise, Joachim followed his criticism of Sabellius and Arius by fulminating: «Oh how perversely in every way he has corrected both, who says that a certain supreme thing common to three persons is a single thing, but that each person is that substance», thus creating a quaternity rather than a trinity in God.[75] In one of the three known copies of the *Figurae* of Joachim (Dresden, Sächsche Landesbibliothek A.121, f. 89r, copied in the late thirteenth century), we find a visual illustration of Joachim's understanding of the heresies of Sabellius, Arius, and then of Lombard's view, introduced as

a French translation (by Andrea Robiglio) of a lecture, accessible online at *Oliviana* 2 (2006). See also his major work on Joachim, *Il tempo dell'Apocalisse. Vita di Gioacchino da Fiore*, Laterza, Rome 2004, 41 and 340-341.

73. M. Reeves, *The Influence of Prophecy in the Later Middle Ages*, Clarendon Press, Oxford 1969, 30-31.

74. «Sed nec ut tres olivas que unius sunt nature sed tamen corporum proprietate disiuncte, neque ut tres ramos uni radici infixos: ut substantiam radicem et tres ramos ypostases arbitreris iuxta aliquorum perfidiam, quod est inducere quaternitatem», Joachim von Fiore, *Psalterium decem cordarum*, I, dist. 1, ed. K.-V. Selge, Monumenta Germaniae Historica, Quellen zur Geistesgeschichte des Mittelalters, Band 20, Hahnsche Buchhandlung, Hannover 2009, 20 = ed. Venice 1527 (repr. Minerva, Frankfurt 1965), f. 229rb.

75. «O quam perverse modis omnibus emendavit utrumque qui dixit unam substantiam esse quandam summam rem communem tribus personis et singulam personam esse illam substantiam. Tale est enim acsi pro substantia ponatur centenarius numerus; pro personis autem denarii tres; aut, si non vult illam dicere maiorem cuiuscumque persone; acsi tres denarii ponerentur pro personis et quartus denarius pro substantia; tanquam si non esset Deus Trinitas sed quaternitas», Joachim von Fiore, *Psalterium decem cordarum*, II, [6], ed. Selge, 341 = ed. Venice 1527 (repr. 1965), f. 277ra-rb.

Perfidia, in which the three divine persons are separated from the divine essence. This contrasts with his representation of *Fides catholica*, in which the three persons issue seamlessly from divine essence.[76] The fact that these figures were physically cut out of a copy of the *Figurae* from the first quarter of the thirteenth century suggests that the official condemnation of Joachim's criticism of Peter Lombard in 1215 was not without effect.[77]

According to the passage quoted by Lateran IV, Joachim argued that the multiplicity of the Trinity was like that of any collectivity. The three persons were multiple and yet one in the same way as many people were said to be one people. The people of the church were not one church as «a certain single thing is common to many, but because of the unity of catholic faith, and one kingdom because of the union of indissoluble charity». To support this, he had adduced the saying of Christ, «I want, Father, that they be one in us, just as we are one, so that they may be perfected as one» (John 17, 21). While Joachim would become widely known for developing an eschatological vision of history, involving the manifestation of the Trinity through an age of the Father, an age of the Son, and an age of the Holy Spirit, he also had a clear vision of the three divine persons as each fully consubstantial with the divine substance. To deny this plurality was to deny the divinity of each of the three persons.

Joachim gave no indication that he was aware of the specific Christological debate that Lombard had provoked through the third book of *Sentences*, signalled by Gerhoch of Reichersberg as problematic in 1163.[78] Rather he was shocked by the passage from

76. M. Reeves and B. Hirsch-Reich, *The Figurae of Joachim of Fiore*, Clarendon Press, Oxford 1972, 212-223; illustrated in Plate 30; reproduced schematically by B. McGinn, *The Calabrian Abbot. Joachim of Fiore in the History of Western Thought*, MacMillan, New York 1985, 165.

77. The image has been cut out of Oxford, Corpus Christi College 255A, ff. 4-14, copied in the first quarter of the thirteenth century, of which an indirect copy has been made in Reggio Emilia, Bibl. Sem., R 1, ff. 1-20, from the second half of the thirteenth century; Reeves and Hirsch-Reich, *The Figurae*, 76-77, 100-102.

78. Gerhoch of Reichersberg, *De Gloria et honore Filii hominis*, PL 194, 1097-8: «Quod sub nomine Augustini Petrus, modernus glossator, intexuit suis glossis, ubi

near the opening of the first book of *Sentences* in which Peter Lombard had insisted that divine essence had not itself generated divine essence as the Son, but rather was a supreme reality quite distinct from the three persons.[79] Joachim read Peter Lombard as contradicting the assertion in the Athanasian Creed about the divinity of the Son of God as "God from God, begotten not made, of one substance with the Father, through whom all things were made."

Joachim's criticism of Peter Lombard's Trinitarian theology is sometimes explained as the result of his desire to extend the hostility of Bernard of Clairvaux towards schoolmen like Peter Abelard and Gilbert of Poitiers. Joachim could be projecting onto Lombard Bernard's criticism of Gilbert's notion that an abstract form, namely *deitas*, was separate from *deus*.[80] Yet Joachim was not questioning schoolmen, without having any idea of the serious theological differences between the major masters of his day. Bernard had helped Peter Lombard during his early studies at Reims and then at Saint-Victor in the 1130s and had been supported by Peter Lombard at Reims in 1148, along with other masters, in arguing against certain propositions made by Gilbert of Poitiers.[81] Bernard's interventions in 1141 and 1148 were directed not against scholastic method in general, but against specific doctrines taught by the two major rivals of Peter Lombard. The fact that one of the earliest surviving manuscripts of the *Sentences* (Troyes MS 900), bearing an inscription with the date 1158, was owned by the College of St Bernard in the thirteenth century suggests that Cistercian students were encouraged to study Lombard's theology.

assignavit homini duliam, Verbo latriam, cum beatus *Augustinus hoc minime senserit. Qui tractans de praedicto scabello adorando, nullam penitus facit mentionem* duliae. Quod praedictus Petrus creditur postea deprehendisse, quia in sententiarum suarum libro tertio, ubi opiniones quorumdam ponit existimantium Deo latriam, et homini duliam exhibendam in Christo, nullam facit mentionem Augustini. Sed in eodem libro, ubi Augustini sententiam commemorat de adorando scabello pedum Domini, penitus nulla est mentio duliae, sicut isti mendaces asserunt, homini assumpto exhibenda».

79. See above n. 18.

80. This view is maintained by Potesta, *Il tempo dell'Apocalisse*, 39.

81. See above, nn. 9, 10.

In England, France and Germany, criticisms of Peter Lombard's orthodoxy were made most loudly, not by Cistercian monks, but by Augustinian canons – in particular Gerhoch of Reichersberg, John of Cornwall, and Walter of Saint-Victor. Joachim's precise awareness of a crucial passage near the opening of the *Sentences* shows that he was an intelligent and perceptive reader, quite different from those critics who made blanket condemnations of Lombard's Christology. Given that a number of allusions to Richard's writing have been identified in the first part of Joachim's *Psalterium*, it seems logical to assume that Joachim was influenced by Richard's criticism of Lombard's Trinitarian theology in developing his own thinking on the subject.[82]

Richard of St-Victor had provided a brilliant example of how abstract theological reflection could be harnessed to Scripture in a way that was very different from that of either Peter Lombard or Gilbert of Poitiers. Rather than reacting against schoolmen in general, Joachim was troubled by a very specific argument of Peter Lombard. While his way of explaining the Trinity was not the same as that of Richard, he shared Richard's conviction that the three persons of the Trinity each communicated divine substance in their fullness, but gave more detail in quoting directly from the *Sentences*. The approach of Richard and Joachim to the Trinity was very different from that of Peter Lombard, who steered away from any formulation of personal experience in analysing doctrine.

Richard of St-Victor's concluding polemic in the *De trinitate* is so similar to that raised by Joachim about the opening of the *Sentences* that Joachim may have been alerted to its argument, either by Richard's treatise or perhaps by students familiar with the novel aspect of this part of Peter Lombard's discussion. While Joachim's notion of concordance between Old and New Testaments, as well as his particular interest in the book of Revelation, is more richly

82. Richard's *De trinitate* is noted in the apparatus to other parts of this opening section of Joachim von Fiore, *Psalterium decem cordarum* I, dist.1, ed. Selge, 18, 32, 40. Selge, 38, also notes that Joachim quotes a passage of Augustine in the abbreviated form supplied by Peter Lombard, *Sententiae* I, d. 8, c. 8, ed. Brady, vol. I, 102, a further sign of the attention with which Joachim studied Peter Lombard.

symbolic than that of Richard of St-Victor, and more acute in its criticism of monastic corruption, there is a continuity of theological concern that should not be ignored.

By the time Richard died in 1173, it was perhaps inevitable that the public school of St-Victor should begin to lose some of its power to attract students to its public school. Walter's attitude to secular masters was more aggressive than that of Richard, and also different from that of Godfrey of St-Victor (d. 1185), whose *Microcosmos* offers a much more nuanced commentary on the various schools of Paris in the late twelfth century.[83] The division within the abbey between their attitudes would mark the end of Saint-Victor as a leading centre of intellectual inquiry.

When Pope Innocent III sided with Lombard in the declaration of Faith of 1215, he was seeking to suppress any lingering voices of criticism being made against a theologian, whose *Four Books of Sentences* were proving an immensely popular foundation for theological study.

Innocent III and Peter Lombard

Why then, after the refusal of Alexander III to respond officially to complaints made against Peter Lombard, did Innocent and his cardinals act so assertively at Lateran IV? One answer might be found in tracing the history of the intellectual preparation for Lateran IV, as John Baldwin has done so well.[84] Lothar de Segni (c. 1160/61-1216) was thoroughly embedded in the key theological networks of his time. He was, as with so many other young clerics of ambition, trained in the liberal arts in the schools of Paris prior to spending many years in the papal curia and then becoming

83. Godfrey of St-Victor, *Microcosmos*, ed. P. Delhaye, Duculot, Lille 1951; Id., *Fons philosophiae*, ed. P. Michaud-Quentin, Namur 1956 (Analecta medievalia Namurcensia, 8); see E.A. Synan, *The Fountain of Philosophy: a Translation of the Twelfth-century Fons philosophiae of Godfrey of Saint Victor*, Pontifical Institute of Mediaeval Studies, Toronto 1972.

84. J. W. Baldwin, *The Intellectual Preparation for the Canon of 1215 against Ordeals*, «Speculum», 36 (1961), 613-656.

Pope in 1198. Lothar spent up to ten years in Paris, from the mid 1170s to the mid 1180s, studying with such eminent scholars as Peter of Poitiers and Peter of Corbeil.[85] There, he studied the foundational disciplines of grammar, dialectic and rhetoric, as well as the emerging field of moral theology as taught at the cathedral school by Peter the Chanter. Innocent could not have avoided the controversies that pitted the crude rhetoric of Walter of St-Victor against the semantic subtleties of the disciples of Peter Lombard. With the death of Richard of St-Victor in 1173, a new set of theologians, schooled in the *Sentences* of Peter Lombard, were offering a new intellectual system in which the emphasis was more firmly placed on the analysis of propositions than on spiritual contemplation leading from the visible to the invisible world.

At Notre-Dame, semantic analysis had become a normal feature of theological and exegetical argument. It had become standard to distinguish between the signification of a term, deriving from its *prima impositio*, and its supposition in a specific case. Under Lombard's influence and even more of Peter of Poitiers, semantic concerns became increasingly important in discussion of the Trinity.[86] Stephen Langton went further in these concerns, affirming that while one could say "God from God" as relating to Person, the noun *essentia* could only refer to divine essence and thus one could not say essence begot essence.[87] One of the masters of this school,

85. J. C. Moore, *Pope Innocent III (1160/61-1216). To root up and to plant*, Brill, Leiden 2003, 8-9. Moore has an excellent bibliography of works concerning Innocent's life and times. For a general introduction, see *Pope Innocent III and his World*, ed. J.C. Moore, B. Bolton, J.M. Powell and C.M. Rousseau, Ashgate Publishing, Farnham, UK 1999. On Innocent III's relationship with the schools, see J.W. Baldwin, *Master's, Princes, and Merchants: The Social Views of Peter the Chanter and His Circle*, 2 vols, Princeton University Press, Princeton 1970.

86. L. Valente, *Logique et théologie. Les écoles parisiennes entre 1150 et 1220*, Vrin, Paris 2008, esp. 173-182 on Peter Lombard and Peter of Poitiers.

87. Quoted by F. Robb, *A Late Thirteenth-Century Attack on the Fourth Lateran Council: The «Liber Contra Lombardum» and Contemporary Debates on the Trinity*, «Rech. Théol. Anc. Méd.», 62 (1995), 110-144, at 128. Langton's account of the statement "Good from God" (*Deum de Deo*) has been analysed more recently by R. Quinto (*Stephen Langton*, in Ph.W. Rosemann [ed.], *Medieval Commentaries on the Sentences of Peter Lombard*, vol. II, Brill, Leiden 2010, 35-78, in particular 64-66).

Peter the Chanter also focused on the use of dialectical reasoning to answer moral problems, providing modes of argumentation and case-studies that would be useful examples for the preacher. The theologians of the school of the Chanter were not only concerned with the high-theory of the Trinity or the Eucharist, but also worried about issues of sacramental and moral integrity, namely how the Church and individual could combine to produce a saved soul.[88] The school of Notre-Dame in this period combined a foundation in semantic analysis with a concern for the pastoral.

A number of these men of the school of Peter the Chanter became Innocent's foremost advisers, in particular Robert de Courson and Stephen Langton. They worked closely with him in reformulating church policy on the interdict and ordeals. In this way, their pastoral program found support in the highest quarters in Rome. They provided Innocent III, in many cases, with the theological firmament on which his ambitions might be justified. Although the Chanter and his disciples had made significant departures from Peter Lombard in terms of the content of his inquiries, they remained – in orientation and location – firmly of his school. They built on his systematisation towards protocols and practices of applied theology. That is, they applied the method evinced most famously and influentially in the *Sentences* towards the construction of a new body of church legislation.

Their influence can be seen at work in language of Lateran IV, which as we have already shown demonstrated very particular knowledge of the history of Christian doctrine. For the papacy to confess *cum Petro*, to cite precisely the passage of the *Sentences* identified by Joachim as marking a subtle, but distinct departure from Augustine was to do much more than clarify a point. Both the pun – *cum Petro* – and the particular endorsement of Peter Lombard's rewording of Augustine's definition of divine substance as

88. The most important work on the Chanter remains Baldwin's *Peter the Chanter* (n. 85 above). In addition, Baldwin has published the aforementioned *Paris et Rome en 1215: les réformes du IVe Concile de Latran*, «Journal des Savants», (1997), 99-124, concentrating closely on the role of the schoolmen as advisors to the Pope.

una summa quaedam res, was to declare a new era in the making of Christian doctrine. The architect of this era was clearly endorsed as Peter Lombard. Read in this way, Lateran IV was a decisive intervention in debates that challenged the reputation of Peter Lombard and his master work.

Conclusion

As we have seen, when the Council confessed *cum Petro*, it confessed also to a «certain one supreme reality ... which alone is the principle of all things, besides which no other principle can be found». The Council gave particular authority to Lombard's concept of the *una quaedam summa res*, itself inspired by a phrase of Augustine in the *De doctrina Christiana*, but also endorsed the distinction Lombard wished to draw between this supreme reality and the three divine persons. Joachim was a careful reader of theology. He identified precisely the passage in which Peter Lombard had silently omitted Augustine's reference in that work to the three persons as plural things. In making this distinction, Peter Lombard was aware of the criticism that Peter Abelard had made against Alberic of Reims regarding the need to distinguish divine essence from divine person. Considered in this light, Lateran IV can be taken as an intervention into one of the key questions of the preceding century: how appropriate was the application of the rules of human logic to divine names? From Berengar onwards, this was the central issue that circled around the schools and caused ink to be spilt, reputations to be jeopardised and genuine enmity to be expressed. At St-Victor, the death of Hugh of St-Victor in 1141 had opened the way to a host of different personalities, each of whom sought to create their own theological synthesis, structured around the notion of a transcendent wisdom that could be accessed through the material world. Peter Lombard, himself a product of its public school, was one of a number of figures who sought to bring together the teaching of Hugh of St-Victor with the more analytic tradition espoused by Peter Abelard. Few theologians agreed with each other about the way a terminological focus could best be combined with the language of spiritual experience. With the advent of Achard of Saint-Victor as its abbot (1155-1161), and then the rise to prominence of Richard of Saint-Victor (d. 1173), Peter Lombard was seen by some Augustinian canons as having betrayed orthodox tradition, in the same way as Bernard of Clairvaux was troubled by the arguments of both Abelard and Gilbert of Poitiers.

While Achard of St-Victor had raised criticisms of Lombard's Christology, it was Richard of St-Victor in his *De trinitate* who supplied the most potent critique of the Trinitarian theology espoused in the first book of the *Sentences*. For Richard, a dialectical approach to theology only served to lead towards spiritual apprehension of a divine mystery. Joachim of Fiore was preacher and theologian. His intellectual debt to the writings of Richard of Saint-Victor deserves further study. Richard's influence would continue to exercise a profound influence in the thirteenth century, notably the anonymous author of a treatise *Contra Lombardum* once mistakenly associated with the school of Joachim of Fiore. For this author, Richard of St-Victor was an important voice continuing to assert that divine essence could indeed generate essence in each of the persons of the Trinity.[89] In their different ways, Richard, Peter Lombard and Joachim himself were all contesting the legacy of Augustine.

Yet the injunction of Lateran IV, with its explicit support for Peter Lombard against the criticisms of his Trinitarian theology formulated by Joachim of Fiore, was of huge influence in articulating a new vision of orthodoxy in the thirteenth century. It did not condemn the ideas of Richard of Saint-Victor, but it marked the end of a period of great diversity about how one might explain the Trinity. Peter Lombard, Richard of Saint-Victor and Joachim

89. *Joachimi abbatis Liber contra Lombardum (Scuola di Gioacchino da Fiore)*, ed. C. Ottaviano, Reale Accademia d'Italia, Roma 1934 (Reale Accademia d'Italia. Studi e documenti, 8). On this work, see the arguments of Fiona Robb that it may have been written in the 1280s in response to the arguments of Peter John Olivi, for which Richard of St-Victor was also a key thinker: F. Robb, *A Late Thirteenth-Century Attack on the Fourth Lateran Council* (n. 87 above), 110-144.

of Fiore were all sophisticated theologians who came up with their own way of presenting the core of Christian doctrine. They competed with each other as to who could present the Trinity most successfully. Those nurtured by the teaching of Richard of St-Victor and Joachim of Fiore about the spiritual realities articulated in theological discourse were suspicious of the distinction Lombard made between divine essence and the three persons of the Trinity and his vision of God as a *summa quaedam res*, a formula derived from a remark of Augustine. Nonetheless, their criticisms did not stop Peter Lombard's definition from gaining official recognition. The Fourth Lateran Council confirmed his authority, and ushered in a new era in the development of scholasticism.

Mark Clark

PETER COMESTOR AND STEPHEN LANGTON: MASTER AND STUDENT, AND CO-MAKERS OF *THE HISTORIA SCHOLASTICA*

The standard chronology of the beginnings of Stephen Langton's long and distinguished career as a teacher of theology in Paris has been that of Maurice Powicke who, writing in 1928, first estimated that Langton began his studies in Paris around 1180.[1] Soon thereafter, however, in an article published in 1930, George Lacombe, citing a passage in Langton's first commentary on the *Historia scholastica* that indicated Langton's ignorance of the fall of Jerusalem in 1187, concluded that Langton had lectured on the *History* sometime before 1187.[2] Powicke, relying upon Lacombe's research and also upon Beryl Smalley's findings that a number of Langton's Old Testament commentaries predated 1190, revised his original estimate accordingly. Quoting the *De viris illustribus* for evidence that Langton had first taught on the arts faculty before becoming the leader of the theology faculty («liberalium artium scolis prefuit; inde theologice scole presidens, theologiam celeberrime docuit»), Powicke wrote of Langton: «If he taught theology after 1180 he must have come to Paris about 1170 ... On the whole, I am disposed to push back the date of Langton's birth and to add ten or twelve years to his life in Paris ... Stephen, if he went to Paris about 1170 or a little earlier, could not have been born be-

1. F.M. Powicke, *Stephen Langton: being the Ford Lectures delivered in the University of Oxford in Hilary Term 1927*. Oxford University Press, Oxford 1928 (repr. Merlin, London 1965), 10.

2. G. Lacombe, *Studies on the Commentaries of Cardinal Stephen Langton, Part I*, «Arch. Hist. Doctr. Litt. M. A.», 5 (1930), 21-23.